Office of Institutional Research
West Valley College

2025-10-14 | Sam Newman, Research Analyst

Re: Community College Survey of Student Engagement (CCSSE), Spring 2024

Executive Summary

The Community College Survey of Student Engagement (CCSSE) provides insights into how West Valley College (WVC) students engage with academics, campus life, work, and family responsibilities. Research shows a positive correlation between CCSSE measures of student engagement and academic outcomes such as GPA, transfer rates, and persistence.[1, 2]

In Spring 2024, 427 WVC students completed CCSSE, which was 6%[3] of the student body. Key strengths included students' positive overall experience at WVC, strong sense of belonging at WVC and confidence in their academic success. These strengths were especially pronounced among first-generation and Latina/Latino students. The primary area for improvement was increasing engagement among part-time students, who reported lower engagement than both WVC full-time students and part-time students at other community colleges.

Main Findings

Sense of Belonging

1. **94% of students described their overall experience as WVC as 'Excellent' or 'Good'.** The proportion of students who reported their experience as 'Excellent' increased by 11 percentage points (pp) from 2022 (44%) to 2024 (55%). This increase was even larger for first-generation students, where 70% rated their experience as 'Excellent', a rise of 20 pp from 2022. Part-time students also showed improvement, with 'Excellent' ratings increasing by 16 pp, from 42% in 2022 to 58% in 2024. Overall, students reported enjoying their WVC experience, especially part-time and first-generation students (see Appendix, p. 17-19).

2. **Roughly nine in ten students (91%) agreed that they belong at WVC.** The proportion of students who 'Strongly Agreed' that they belong increased by 9 pp in 2024, from 25% to 34%, suggesting that WVC is fostering a welcoming environment. A similar percentage of students (89%) reported feeling seen by faculty and staff (see Appendix, p. 19-21).

3. **Ninety percent (90%) of students agreed that WVC prioritizes mental-health and emotional well-being.** First-generation students were slightly more likely to agree (94%), suggesting that they feel particularly supported emotionally (see Appendix, p. 19).

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[1] Mandarino, Carlo. "Assessing the validity of CCSSE in an Ontario college: Assessing the validity of Community College Survey of Student Engagement in an Ontario college." (2010).

[2] McClenney, Kay M., and C. Nathan Marti. "Exploring Relationships between Student Engagement and Student Outcomes in Community Colleges: Report on Validation Research. Working Paper." *Community College Survey of Student Engagement* (2006).

[3] Credit student headcount for Spring 2024 was 7,114 (source: Precision Campus).

Academic

1. **Students reported high levels of engagement within and outside of the classroom.** Around seven out of ten students (72%) frequently contributed to class discussions or asked questions during class, an 11 pp increase from 2022 (61%) and higher than cohort colleges (65%). Additionally, about half of surveyed students (51%) said they commonly discussed ideas outside of the classroom, a six pp increase from 2022. These results suggest that some students are rigorously engaging with course content (see Appendix, p. 34).

2. **WVC has room to improve in how frequent instructors and advisors discuss grades, assignments and career goals with students.** Fewer than half (44%) of students reported frequently discussing grades or assignments with instructors. Less than a third (29%) of students said they discussed their career plans with an instructor or advisor. While WVC full-time students discussed their career plans as often as full-time students at cohort colleges, part-time students were nine percentage points less likely (23%) to have these conversations than part-time students at cohort colleges (see Appendix, p. 36).

3. **Relative to students at cohort colleges, learning outcomes for WVC full-time students were strong, but much lower for WVC part-time students.** Across the seven learning outcomes surveyed, WVC full-time students scored higher than cohort full-time students on six out of seven questions (e.g., solving numerical problems). However, WVC part-time students scored higher than cohort part-time students on only one out of seven questions. Part-time students may need additional academic support (see Appendix, p. 40-41).

Student Services

1. **First-generation and Latina/o students were most likely to use the eight services surveyed.** First-generation students were more likely than non-first-generation students to use all eight services surveyed, and Latina/o students were most likely to use five out of the eight services. The most utilized service for both groups was academic advising, with four out of five (80%) first-generation students and 84% of Latina/o students using the service at least once in 2023-24. These results suggest that historically disproportionately impacted groups both can access and have a desire to use support services (see Appendix, p. 54-55).

2. **The proportion of students who reported 'Very Satisfied' for each of the eight services surveyed increased by nearly double-digits percentage points (9 pts or higher) from 2022 to 2024.** The three services with the largest improvement were Tutoring (20 pp), Student Organizations (20 pp), and Career Counseling (18 pp). The service with the highest overall rate of satisfaction was Services for Students with Disabilities, with more than seven out of ten students (71%) reporting they were 'Very Satisfied' (see Appendix, p. 51).

3. **Four services received less unique student visitors in 2024 than in 2022.** Despite higher reported satisfaction, the following services saw a decline in unique visitors: Transfer Counseling (-18 pp), Academic Advising (-9 pp), Career Counseling (-5 pp), and Library Resources and Services (-5 pp). Further research could explore what factors led to these declines (see Appendix, p. 52).

Background

WVC administered CCSSE in Spring 2024 to better understand students' engagement with academics, campus services, and responsibilities outside the classroom. The college also administered CCSSE in 2022 and plans to launch the survey again in Spring 2026. The Institutional Research Office hopes that this longitudinal data will

reveal trends to improve understanding of students' experience at WVC and support planning efforts aimed at improving academic and social outcomes for all WVC students.

CCSSE organizes its survey questions into five dimensions of engagement: Active Learning and Collaborative Learning, Student-Faculty Interaction, Support for Learners, Academic Challenge, and Student Effort.[4] Each dimension of engagement allows readers to quickly understand WVC's performance across multiple questions and to compare results against other community colleges. In 2024, 501 community colleges participated in CCSSE, and WVC was placed in the medium cohort[5], which is composed of 120 medium colleges across the United States.[6]

Administration

In 2024, WVC administered the survey online through Canvas from April 8 to May 11, 2024. The survey was sent to 6,287 students and 427 students responded, resulting in a response rate of 8%. This was fewer respondents than in 2022 (683 responses), when the survey was administered on paper in WVC classrooms. Incentives in 2024 included a raffle to win a $25 gift card for the first 40 students and an iPad for the first 100 students to respond. Respondents had to be over 18 and indicate their enrollment status (part-time or full-time) for their responses to be valid.

Demographics of Respondents

Full-time and female students were overrepresented in the survey by 38% and 8%, respectively (Figure 1). Overrepresentation by these two groups is common across the 501 colleges, which is adjusted by assigning weights based on respondents' enrollment status and gender, increasing the weight of responses from part-time and male students while decreasing the weight of responses from full-time and female students. The percentage of first-generation students surveyed closely matches the percentage of first-generation students enrolled at WVC in Spring 2024. Given the weighting adjustments and the proportionate representation of first-generation students, the results are generalizable to the broader WVC student population.

Figure 1: Demographics of Student Respondents

Student Group	% of Survey Population	% of WVC Population
Full-Time	**69%**	**31%**
Part-Time	**35%**	**69%**
Males	**31%**	**44%**
Females	**64%**	**56%**
First Generation	**28%**	**30%**
Not-First Generation	**72%**	**70%**

[4] Some questions are not placed into any of the Dimensions of Engagement.
[5] Colleges in the medium cohort have between 4,500 to 7,999 credit-enrolled students.
[6] See Appendix A (page 8) for list of community colleges.

Dimensions of Student Engagement

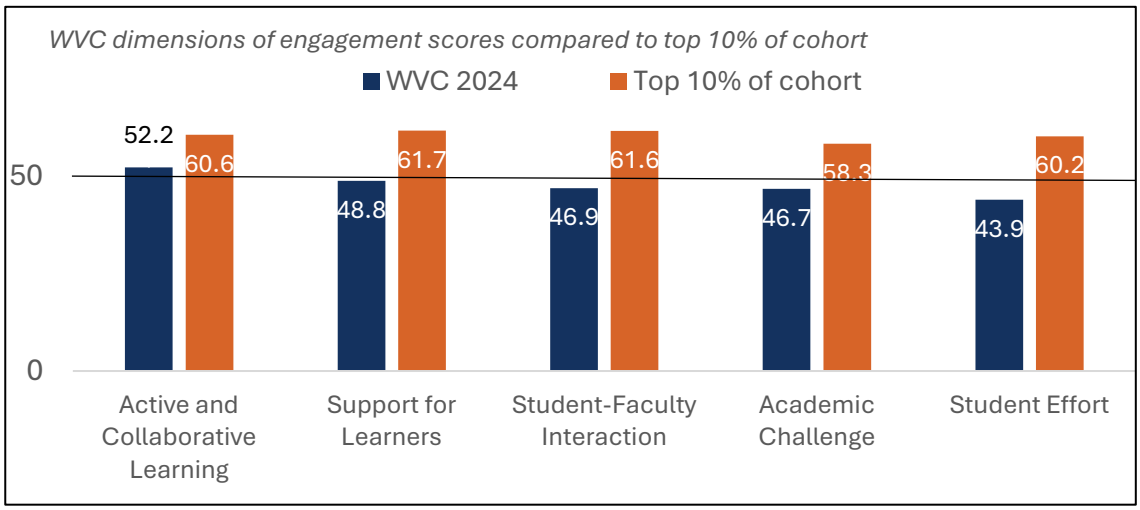
CCSSE's dimensions of student engagement are groups of related survey questions that focus on "institutional practices and student behaviors that promote student engagement – and that are positively related to student learning and persistence".[7] The five dimensions of engagement are Active and Collaborative Learning, Student-Faculty Interaction, Support for Learners, Academic Challenge, and Student Effort.[8]

CCSSE standardizes each dimension's score to 50, which represents the average, or mean, score for cohort colleges.[9] Standardization allows colleges to easily compare their performance across the five dimensions with other community colleges in their cohort. Differences less than 2.5 points are very small, 5 points is small but worth noting, 12 points is moderate and often meaningful, and 20 points is a large and significant effect.

There are a few limitations when interpreting these results. First, differences beyond college size can affect dimensions of engagement scores such as the academic preparation of students (e.g., average HS GPA), regional context (e.g., state or county of college) or campus culture. If a college differs substantially from the cohort, the benchmark may be an unfair comparison. WVC's cohort consists of 120 medium-sized community colleges, which provides a diverse reference group, though some contextual variation likely remains. Second, CCSSE and WVC use different terminology for positions and places on campus. For instance, CCSSE uses 'advisor' to describe what WVC students typically refer to as "counselors". These discrepancies may lead to lower reported engagement in certain categories. Specifically, Student Effort was notably lower than other dimensions (43.9), but two questions in this section referenced "skill labs" and "computer labs," which are names WVC doesn't use. Adjusting for this, WVC's true Student Effort score is likely comparable to the other dimensions (approximately 46–48), but this is an estimate.

West Valley College scored highest in Active and Collaborative Learning (52.2) and lowest in Student Effort (43.9) (Figure 2). Scores for Student-Faculty Interaction, Academic Challenge, and Support for Learners were slightly below the cohort average, highlighting areas for continued growth. All five dimensions were below the top 10% of cohort colleges, with differences ranging from eight to sixteen points.

Figure 2: WVC scored close to the average (50) for most dimensions of engagement, but lags behind the top 10% of the cohort.



[7] Community College Survey of Student Engagement. (2022). *How benchmarks are calculated*. https://ccsse.org/survey/docs/HowBenchmarksAreCalculated_2022.pdf

[8] See Appendix B (page 12) for list of survey questions that compose each dimension of engagement.

[9] The standard deviation is 25 points, so 95% of all dimensions of engagement scores are between zero and 100.

Although WVC scored above the cohort average in only one out of five dimensions, full-time students performed as well as or better than full-time students at cohort colleges in four out of five dimensions (Figure 3). In contrast, part-time students at WVC performed at or above their cohort peers in only one of the five dimensions (Figure 4). These results suggest that while WVC full-time students are as engaged, or more engaged, than their peers at other colleges, WVC part-time students are notably less engaged, highlighting an important area for improvement.

Figure 3: WVC full-time students scored as well as (within one point) or better than full-time students at cohort colleges for four out of five dimensions of engagement.

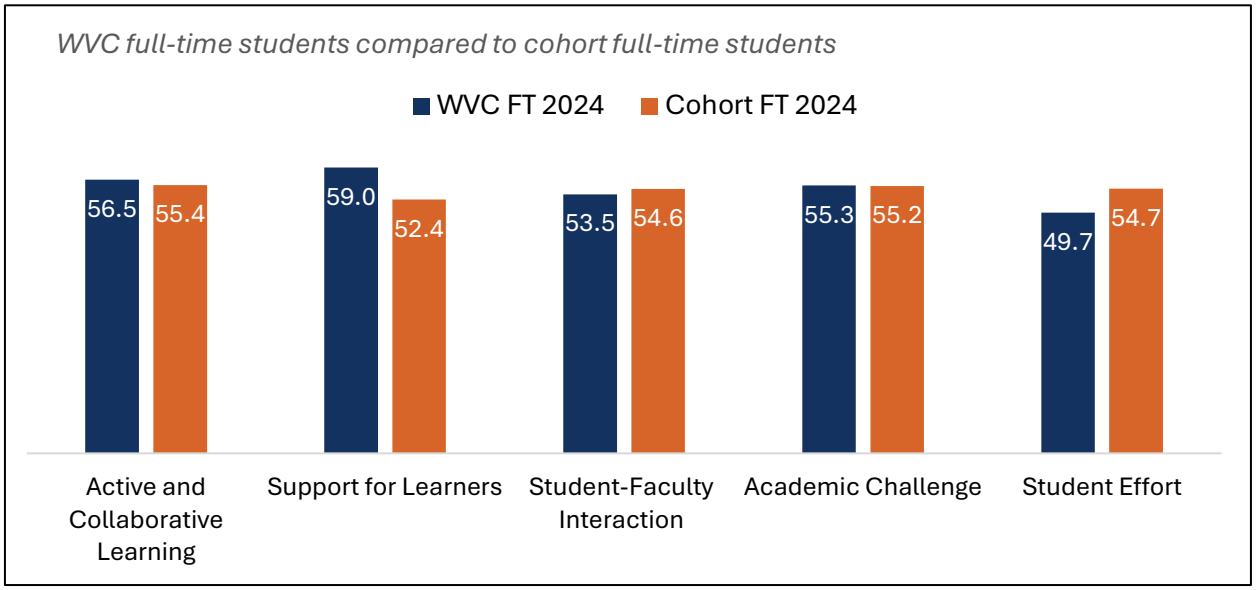
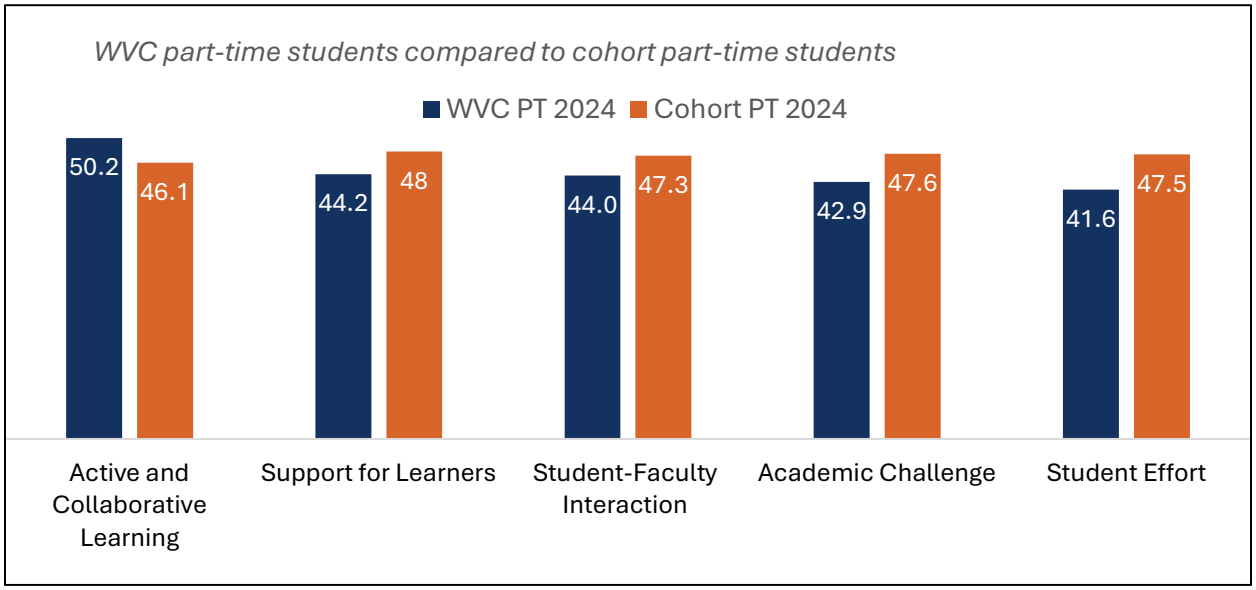


Figure 4: WVC part-time students scored as well as (within one point) or better than part-time students at cohort colleges for one out of five dimensions of engagement



Recommendation

A consistent finding across the three CCSSE presentations is that WVC full-time students are performing as well as or better than full-time students at cohort colleges, while WVC part-time students seem to be less engaged than part-time students at cohort colleges. The Institutional Research Office encourages departments to reflect on how they currently serve part-time students and how they aspire to serve them moving forward.

Appendix

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Appendix A. List of medium cohort colleges

Aims Community College	Greeley	CO	2023
Alvin Community College	Alvin	TX	2023
Bossier Parish Community College	Bossier City	LA	2022
Butler Community College	El Dorado	KS	2024
Cañada College	Redwood City	CA	2024
Central Community College	Grand Island	NE	2023
Century College	White Bear Lake	MN	2024
Chattanooga State Community College	Chattanooga	TN	2023
Chemeketa Community College	Salem	OR	2024
Clark State College	Springfield	OH	2024
Clovis Community College	Fresno	CA	2023
Coastal Alabama Community College	Bay Minette	AL	2023
College of Central Florida	Ocala	FL	2022
College of Southern Idaho	Twin Falls	ID	2023
College of Southern Maryland	La Plata	MD	2023
Colorado Mountain College	Glenwood Springs	CO	2023
Columbia State Community College	Columbia	TN	2023
Community College of Denver	Denver	CO	2024
Doña Ana Community College	Las Cruces	NM	2023
Eastern Iowa Community Colleges	Davenport	IA	2023
Elizabethtown Community & Technical College	Elizabethtown	KY	2024
Essex County College	Newark	NJ	2022
Everett Community College	Everett	WA	2024
Forsyth Technical Community College	Winston-Salem	NC	2023
Frederick Community College	Frederick	MD	2024
Gaston College	Dallas	NC	2024
GateWay Community College	Phoenix	AZ	2023
Germanna Community College	Locust Grove	VA	2023

Heartland Community College	Normal	IL	2023
Horry-Georgetown Technical College	Conway	SC	2024
Illinois Central College	East Peoria	IL	2024
Itawamba Community College	Fulton	MS	2024
Kalamazoo Valley Community College	Kalamazoo	MI	2024
Kansas City Kansas Community College	Kansas City	KS	2023
Kapi`olani Community College	Honolulu	HI	2024
Lakeland Community College	Kirtland	OH	2023
Lane Community College	Eugene	OR	2024
Lee College	Baytown	TX	2022
Leeward Community College	Pearl City	HI	2024
Lehigh Carbon Community College	Schnecksville	PA	2024
Lincoln Land Community College	Springfield	IL	2024
Los Medanos College	Pittsburg	CA	2023
Massasoit Community College	Brockton	MA	2022
McLennan Community College	Waco	TX	2024
Middlesex Community College	Lowell	MA	2022
Mohawk Valley Community College	Utica	NY	2022
Monterey Peninsula College	Monterey	CA	2023
Motlow State Community College	Tullahoma	TN	2023
Mott Community College	Flint	MI	2023
Mt. Hood Community College	Gresham	OR	2024
Nashville State Community College	Nashville	TN	2024
Navarro College	Corsicana	TX	2024
North Hennepin Community College	Brooklyn Park	MN	2022
North Idaho College	Coeur dAlene	ID	2023
Northeast Community College	Norfolk	NE	2023
Northeast Lakeview College	Universal City	TX	2023
Northeast State Community College	Blountville	TN	2023
Northwest Florida State College	Niceville	FL	2022

Oakton Community College	Des Plaines	IL	2024
Ocean County College	Toms River	NJ	2022
Odessa College	Odessa	TX	2024
Olympic College	Bremerton	WA	2024
Paradise Valley Community College	Phoenix	AZ	2023
Passaic County Community College	Paterson	NJ	2023
Piedmont Virginia Community College	Charlottesville	VA	2023
Pierce College District	Lakewood	WA	2023
Pueblo Community College	Pueblo	CO	2022
Raritan Valley Community College	Branchburg	NJ	2024
Red Rocks Community College	Lakewood	CO	2023
Reynolds Community College	Richmond	VA	2022
Roane State Community College	Harriman	TN	2023
Rock Valley College	Rockford	IL	2023
San Jose City College	San Jose	CA	2023
San Juan College	Farmington	NM	2023
Scottsdale Community College	Scottsdale	AZ	2023
Somerset Community College	Somerset	KY	2024
Southcentral Kentucky Community and Technical College	Bowling Green	KY	2024
Southern Maine Community College	South Portland	ME	2022
Southwest Tennessee Community College	Memphis	TN	2023
Southwest Texas Junior College	Uvalde	TX	2023
Spartanburg Community College	Spartanburg	SC	2024
Spokane Community College	Spokane	WA	2022
St. Charles Community College	St. Louis	MO	2023
Tacoma Community College	Tacoma	WA	2024
Tarrant County College Northwest Campus	Fort Worth	TX	2022
Tarrant County College South Campus	Fort Worth	TX	2022
Tarrant County College Trinity River Campus	Fort Worth	TX	2022
Temple College	Temple	TX	2022

Texas Southmost College	Brownsville	TX	2023
Tompkins Cortland Community College	Dryden	NY	2022
Trinity Valley Community College	Athens	TX	2023
UCNJ Union College of Union County, NJ	Cranford	NJ	2023
University of Cincinnati Blue Ash College	Cincinnati	OH	2023
University of Cincinnati Clermont College	Batavia	OH	2023
Volunteer State Community College	Gallatin	TN	2023
Walters State Community College	Morristown	TN	2023
Waubonsee Community College	Sugar Grove	IL	2024
West Kentucky Community and Technical College	Paducah	KY	2022
West Valley College	Saratoga	CA	2024
Wharton County Junior College	Wharton	TX	2023

Appendix B. List of survey questions for each dimension of engagement

Active and Collaborative Learning

Students learn more when they are actively involved in their education and have opportunities to think about and apply what they are learning in different settings. Through collaborating with others to solve problems or master challenging content, students develop valuable skills that prepare them to deal with the kinds of situations and problems they will encounter in the workplace, the community, and their personal lives.

CCSSE Items	
4a	Frequency: Asked questions in class or contributed to class discussions
4b	Frequency: Made a class presentation
4f	Frequency: Worked with other students on projects during class
4g	Frequency: Worked with classmates outside of class to prepare class assignments
4h	Frequency: Tutored or taught other students (paid or voluntary)
4i	Frequency: Participated in a community-based project (service-learning activity) as part of a regular course
4q	Frequency: Discussed ideas from your readings or classes with others outside of class (students, family members, co-workers, etc.)

Student Effort

Students' behaviors contribute significantly to their learning and the likelihood that they will attain their educational goals. "Time on task" is a key variable, and there are a variety of settings and means through which students may apply themselves to the learning process.

CCSSE Items	
4c	Frequency: Prepared two or more drafts of a paper or assignment before turning it in
4d	Frequency: Worked on a paper or project that required integrating ideas or information from various sources
4e	Frequency: Come to class without completing readings or assignments
6b	Number of books read on your own (not assigned) for personal enjoyment or academic enrichment
10a	Hours spent per week: Preparing for class (studying, reading, writing, rehearsing, doing homework, etc.)
12d1	Frequency of use: Peer or other tutoring
12e1	Frequency of use: Skill labs (writing, math, etc.)
12h1	Frequency of use: Computer lab

Academic Challenge

Challenging intellectual and creative work is central to student learning and collegiate quality. Ten survey items address the nature and amount of assigned academic work, the complexity of cognitive tasks presented to students, and the standards faculty members use to evaluate student performance.

CCSSE Items	
4o	Frequency: Worked harder than you thought you could to meet an instructor's standards or expectations
5b	Amount of emphasis in coursework: Analyzing the basic elements of an idea, experience, or theory
5c	Amount of emphasis in coursework: Forming a new idea or understanding from various pieces of information
5d	Amount of emphasis in coursework: Making judgments about the value or soundness of information, arguments, or methods
5e	Amount of emphasis in coursework: Applying theories or concepts to practical problems or in new situations
5f	Amount of emphasis in coursework: Using information you have read or heard to perform a new skill
6a	Number of assigned textbooks, manuals, books, or packets of course readings
6c	Number of written papers or reports of any length
7	Rate the extent to which your examinations have challenged you to do your best work
9a	Amount of emphasis by college: Encouraging you to spend significant amounts of time studying

Student-Faculty Interaction

In general, the more interaction students have with their teachers, the more likely they are to learn effectively and persist toward achievement of their educational goals. Personal interaction with faculty members strengthens students' connections to the college and helps them focus on their academic progress. Working with an instructor on a project or serving with faculty members on a college committee lets students see first-hand how experts identify and solve practical problems. Through such interactions, faculty members become role models, mentors, and guides for continuous, lifelong learning.

CCSSE Items	
4j	Frequency: Used e-mail to communicate with an instructor
4k	Frequency: Discussed grades or assignments with an instructor
4l	Frequency: Talked about career plans with an instructor or advisor
4m	Frequency: Discussed ideas from your readings or classes with instructors outside of class
4n	Frequency: Received prompt feedback (written or oral) from instructors on your performance
4p	Frequency: Worked with instructors on activities other than coursework

Support for Learners

Students perform better and are more satisfied at colleges that are committed to their success and cultivate positive working and social relationships among different groups on campus. Community college students also benefit from services targeted to assist them with academic and career planning, academic skill development, and other areas that may affect learning and retention.

CCSSE Items	
9b	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the support you need to help you succeed at this college
9c	Amount of emphasis by college: Encouraging contact among students from different economic, social, and racial or ethnic backgrounds
9d	Amount of emphasis by college: Helping you cope with your non-academic responsibilities (work, family, etc.)
9e	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the support you need to thrive socially
9f	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the financial support you need to afford your education
12a1	Frequency of use: Academic advising/planning
12b1	Frequency of use: Career counseling

Appendix C. CCSSE all staff / sense of belonging slides

Background

West Valley College

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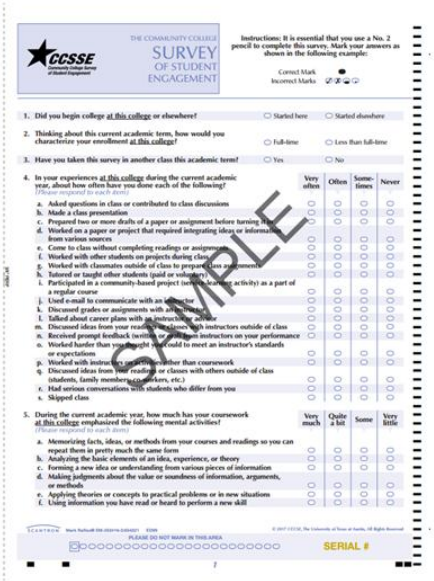
Community College Survey of Student Engagement (CCSSE)

- CCSSE measures student engagement which correlates with academic success
- Cohorts
  - 501 community colleges (link)
    - 120 medium colleges (link)
- Administered Spring 2022 and Spring 2024
- 3 presentations and report


CCSSE
THE COMMUNITY COLLEGE SURVEY OF STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

Instructions: It is essential that you use a No. 2 pencil to complete this survey. Mark your answers as shown in the following example:

Correct Mark ●
Incorrect Marks ✓ ✗ ◐ ◒

1. Did you begin college at this college or elsewhere? ○ Started here ○ Started elsewhere
2. Thinking about this current academic term, how would you characterize your enrollment at this college? ○ Full-time ○ Less than full-time
3. Have you taken this survey in another class this academic term? ○ Yes ○ No
4. In your experiences at this college during the current academic year, about how often have you done each of the following? (Please respond to each item)

	Very often	Often	Some-times	Never
a. Asked questions in class or contributed to class discussions	○	○	○	○
b. Made a class presentation	○	○	○	○
c. Prepared two or more drafts of a paper or assignment before turning it in	○	○	○	○
d. Worked on a paper or project that required integrating ideas or information from various sources	○	○	○	○
e. Come to class without completing readings or assignments	○	○	○	○
f. Worked with other students on projects during class	○	○	○	○
g. Worked with classmates outside of class to prepare class assignments	○	○	○	○
h. Tutored or taught other students (paid or volunteer)	○	○	○	○
i. Participated in a community-based project (service-learning activity) as a part of a regular course	○	○	○	○
j. Used e-mail to communicate with an instructor	○	○	○	○
k. Discussed grades or assignments with an instructor	○	○	○	○
l. Talked about career plans with an instructor or advisor	○	○	○	○
m. Discussed ideas from your readings or classes with instructors outside of class	○	○	○	○
n. Received prompt feedback (written or oral) from instructors on your performance	○	○	○	○
o. Worked harder than you thought you could to meet an instructor's standards or expectations	○	○	○	○
p. Worked with instructors on activities other than coursework	○	○	○	○
q. Discussed ideas from your readings or classes with others outside of class (students, family members, co-workers, etc.)	○	○	○	○
r. Had serious conversations with students who differ from you	○	○	○	○
s. Skipped class	○	○	○	○

5. During the current academic year, how much has your coursework at this college emphasized the following mental activities? (Please respond to each item)

	Very much	Quite a bit	Some	Very little
a. Memorizing facts, ideas, or methods from your courses and readings so you can repeat them in pretty much the same form	○	○	○	○
b. Analyzing the basic elements of an idea, experience, or theory	○	○	○	○
c. Forming a new idea or understanding from various pieces of information	○	○	○	○
d. Making judgments about the value or soundness of information, arguments, or methods	○	○	○	○
e. Applying theories or concepts to practical problems or in new situations	○	○	○	○
f. Using information you have read or heard to perform a new skill	○	○	○	○

SCANTRON
PLEASE DO NOT MARK IN THIS AREA
SERIAL #

SAMPLE

West Valley College

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CCSSE Administration

Survey Admin

- April 08 - May 11, 2024
- Online
- Incentive
  - Raffle for $25 gift card (first 40 students) + iPad (first 100 students)

Responses

- Survey count: 427 (2022: 683)
- Number of students who were sent survey: 6,287
- Online response rate: 8%

Respondents had to:

- Be over 18
- Turn in a valid survey
- Indicate enrollment status (full-time v. part-time)

West Valley College

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CCSSE Survey Results:

Overall Experience and Culture of Belonging

West Valley College

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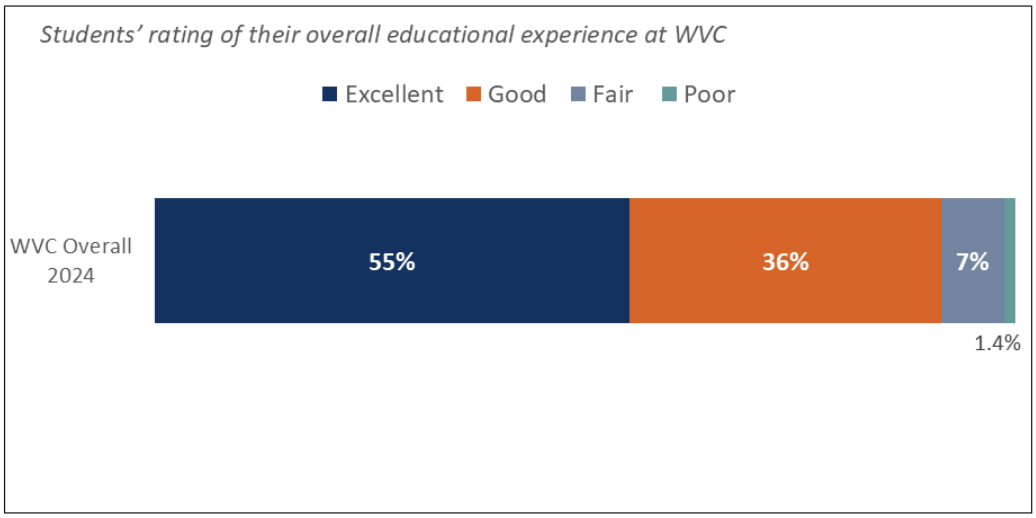
92% of students described experience at WVC as 'Excellent' or 'Good'



West Valley College

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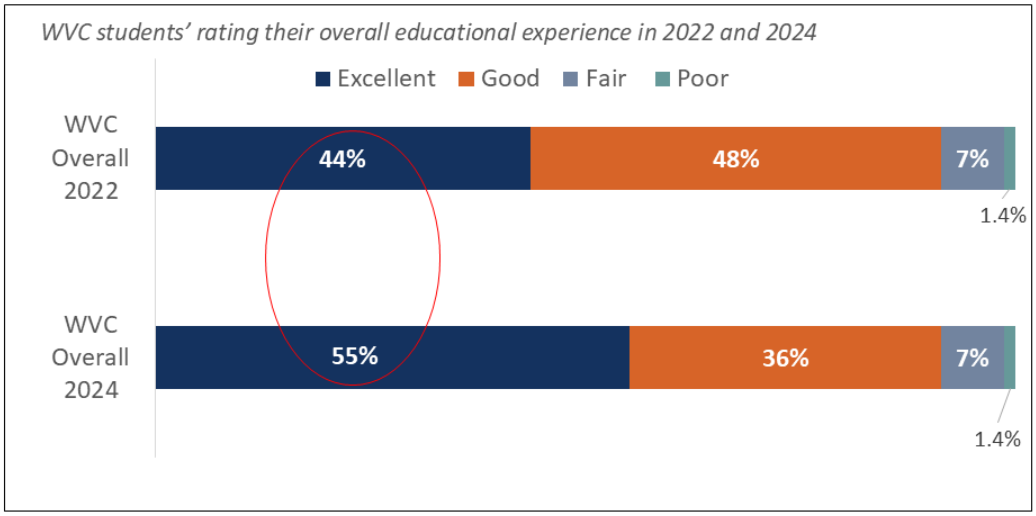
Proportion of students who described experience at WVC as 'Excellent' increased by 11 pp



West Valley College

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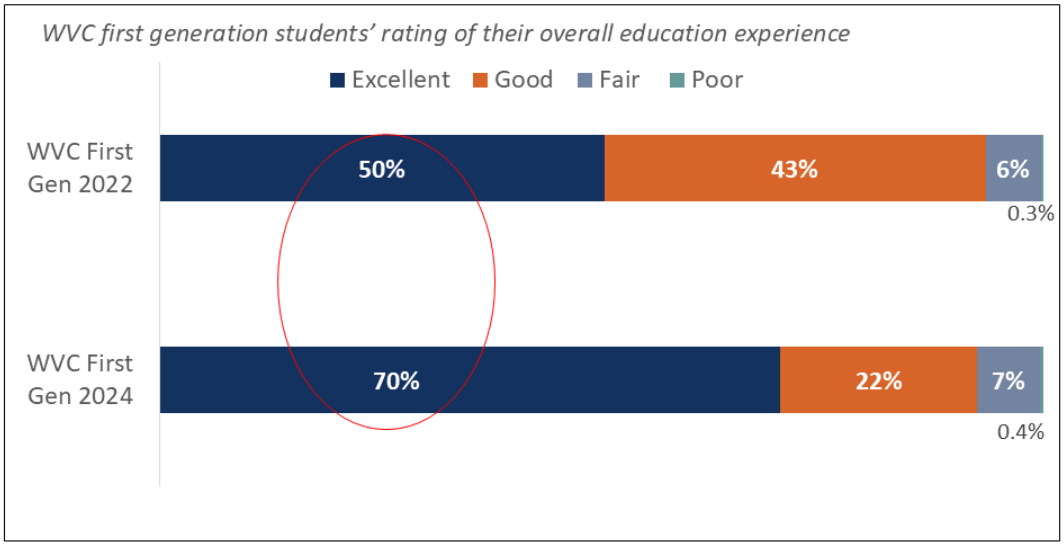
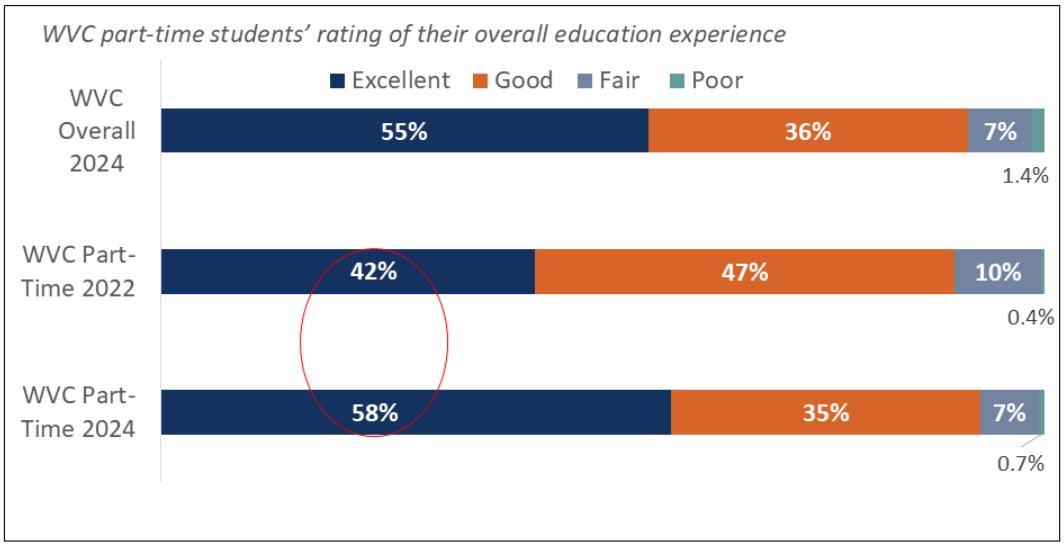
More first gen students rated their WVC as 'Excellent' by 20 pp



West Valley College

11

Part-time students showed 16 pp increase in ranking WVC as 'Excellent'



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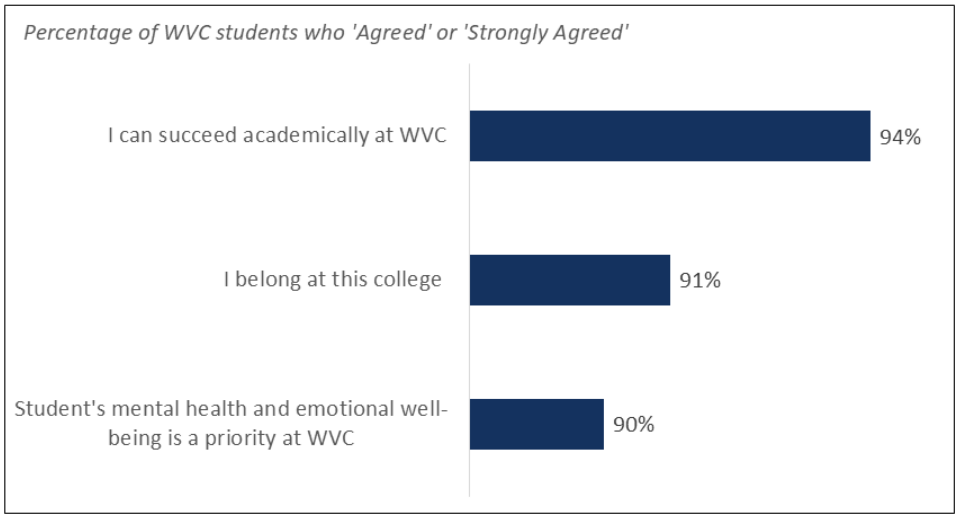
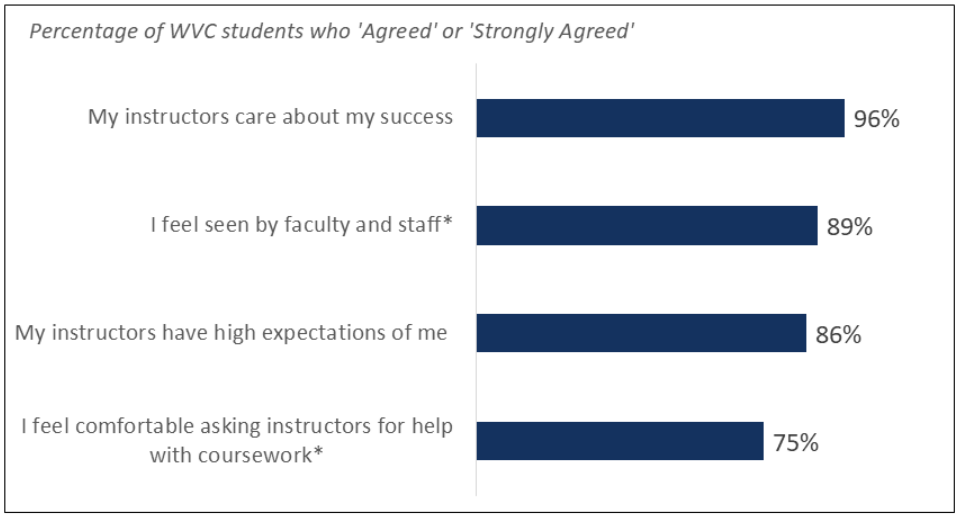
94% of WVC students felt they can succeed academically



West Valley College

96% of WVC students felt their instructors cared about their success



** Original question was negatively phrased. For reporting purposes, phrasing was changed to be positive (i.e., I feel invisible to faculty and staff)*

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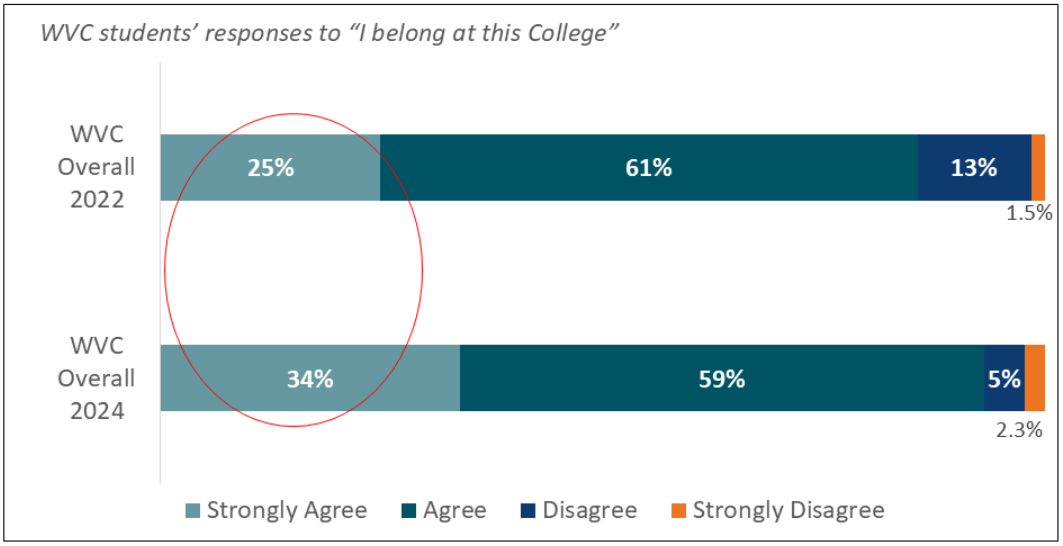
More students 'Strongly Agree' that they belong at WVC (9 pp)



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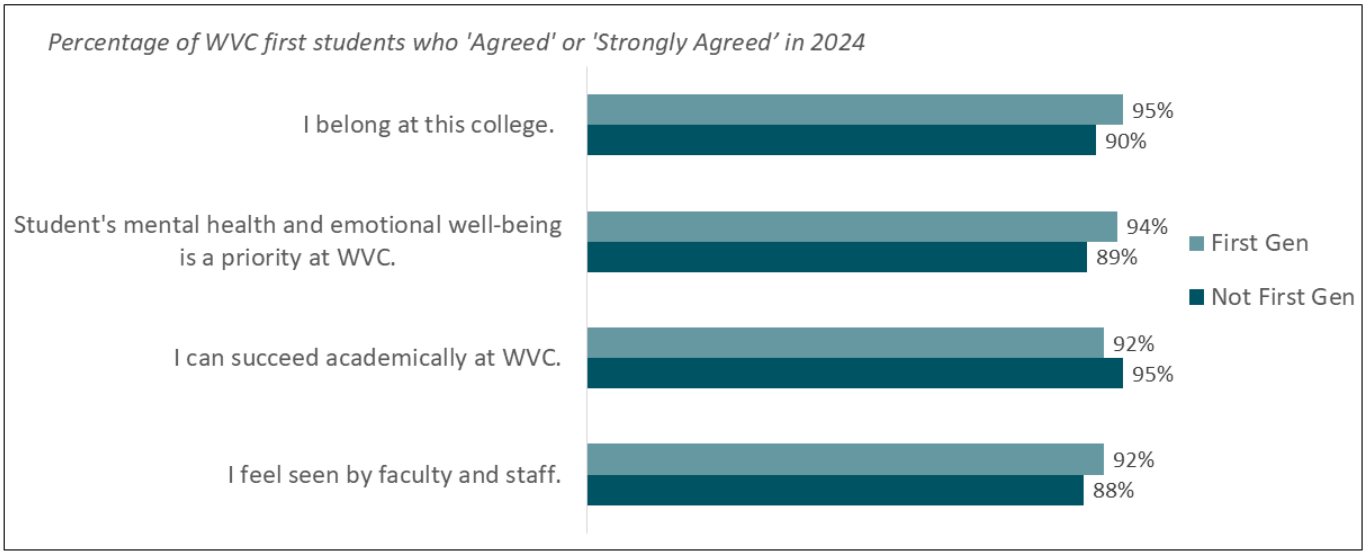
16

First gen students reported a high sense of belonging



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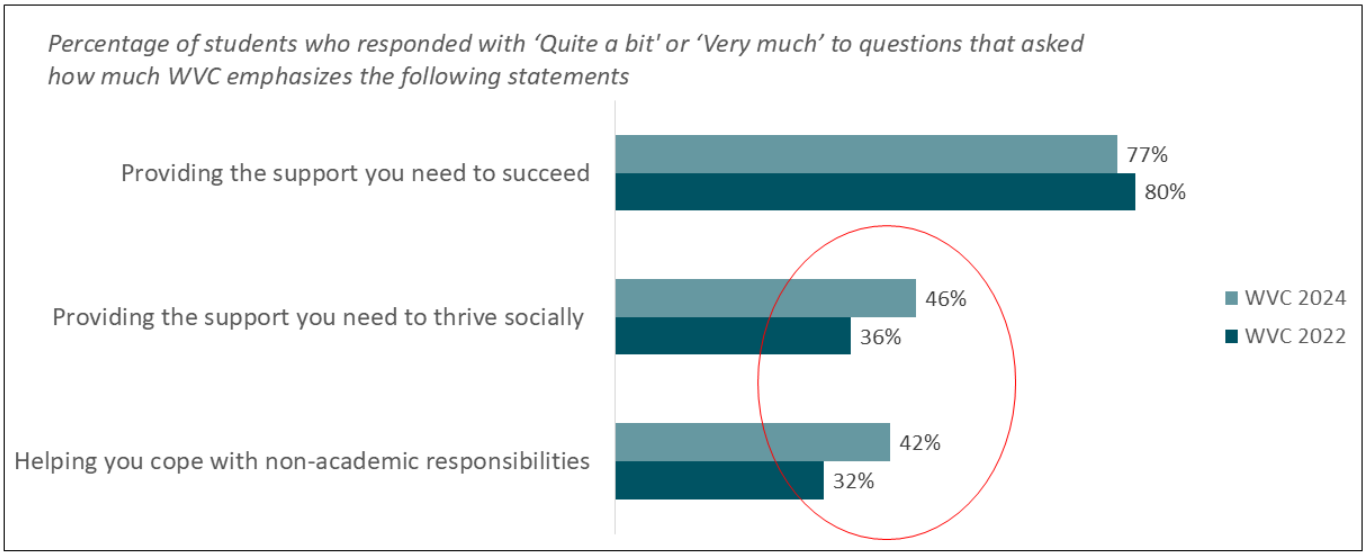
17

More students felt social and non-academic support (10 pp)



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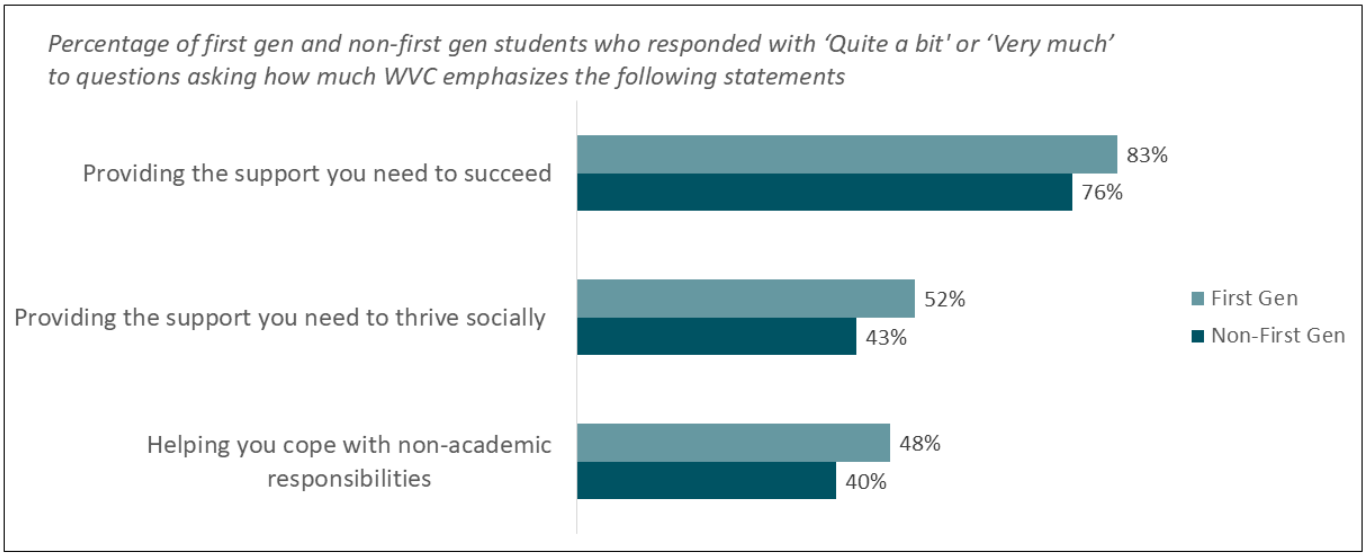
18

More first gen students felt supported than non-first gen students



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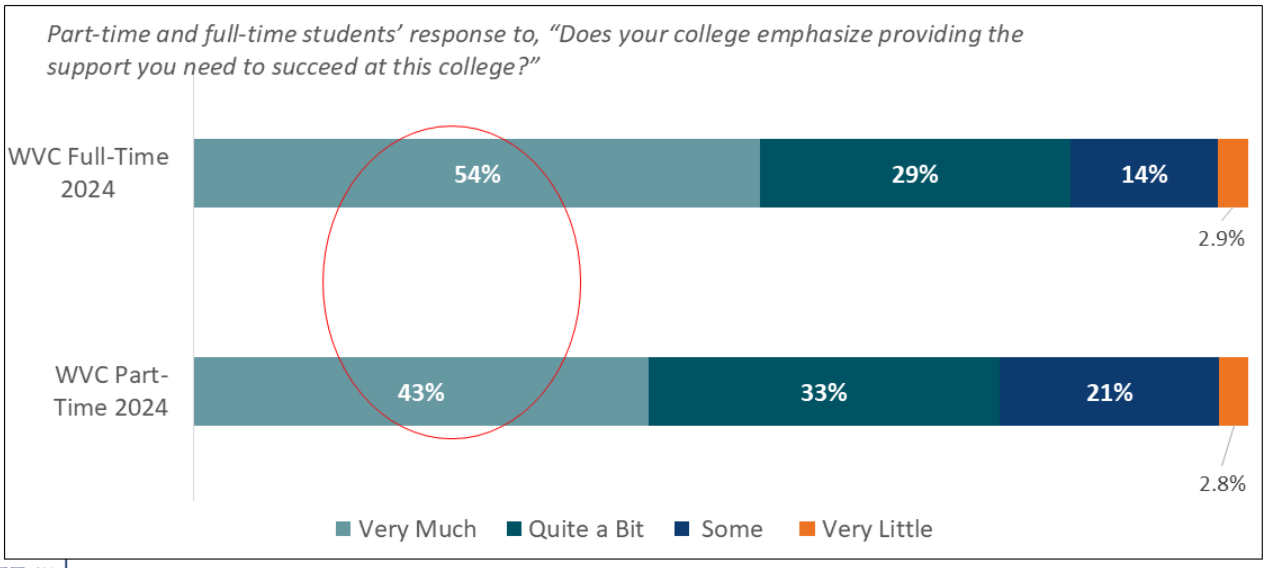
19

Full-time were more likely to feel 'Very Much' supported than part-time (11pp)



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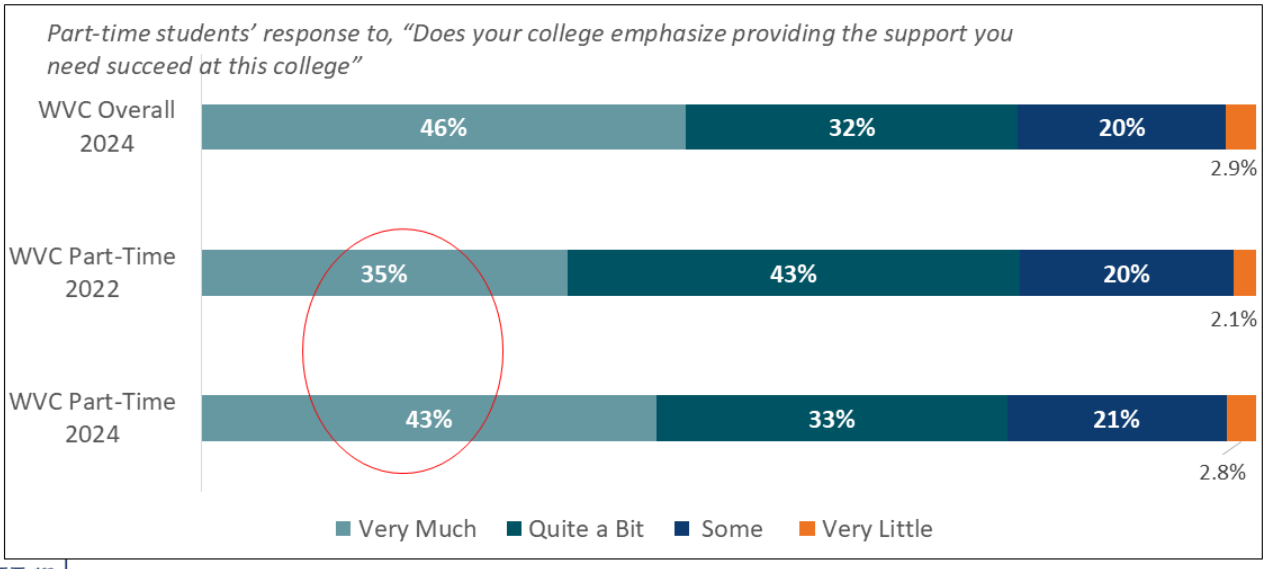
Part-time showed improvement in feeling 'Very Much' supported (8 pp)



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CCSSE Dimensions of Student Engagement

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Dimensions of Engagement Correlate with Student Success

- Marti and McClenny, 2006
  - Significant association with GPA, degree completion, and academic milestones
  - 'Active and Collaborative Learning' and 'Academic Challenge' strongly predicted credit completion ratio
  - 'Support for Learners' consistently correlated with persistence
  - Academic Challenge had strongest impact on academic measures
- Mandarino and Mattern, 2010
  - Positive relationship with cumulative GPA, credit completion, and passing courses with 'C' or higher
  - 'Student Effort' was significantly correlated with GPA

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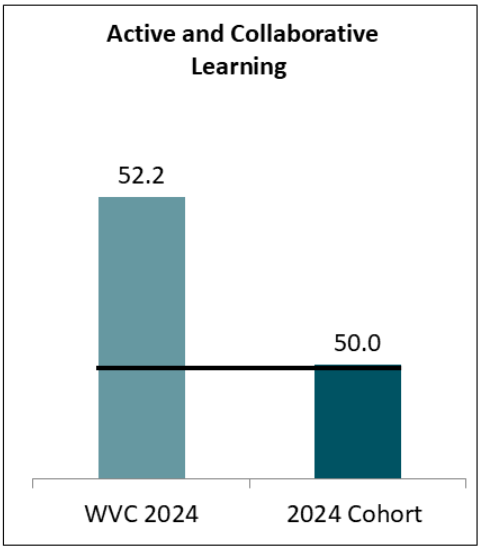
Each Dimension is a Composite Score

1. Active Collaboration

4a	Frequency: Asked questions in class or contributed to class discussions
4b	Frequency: Made a class presentation
4f	Frequency: Worked with other students on projects during class
4g	Frequency: Worked with classmates outside of class to prepare class assignments
4h	Frequency: Tutored or taught other students (paid or voluntary)
4i	Frequency: Participated in a community-based project (service-learning activity) as part of a regular course
4q	Frequency: Discussed ideas from your readings or classes with others outside of class (students, family members, co-workers, etc.)

LINK: How dimensions of engagement are calculated



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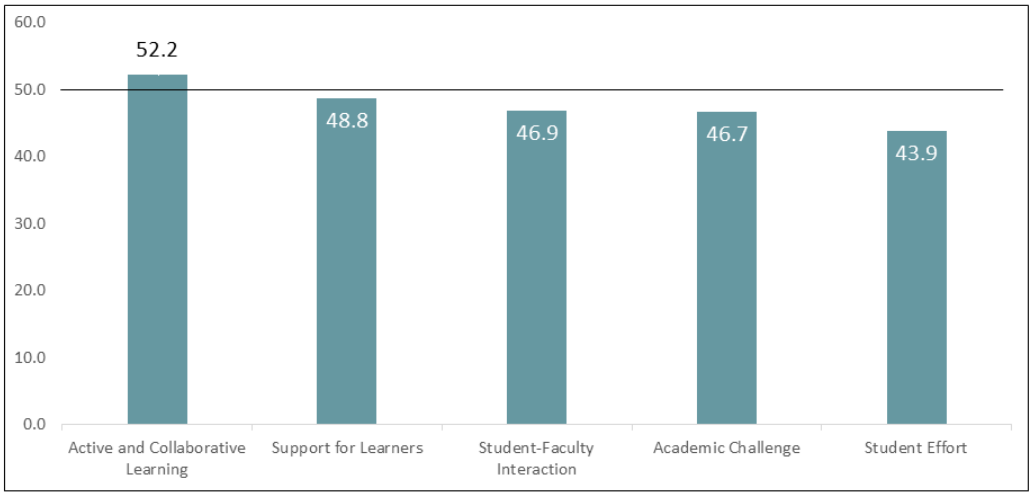
WVC has room for improvement in 4 out of 5 dimensions of engagement



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Limitations of Dimensions of Engagement

2. Student Effort

6b	Number of books read on your own (not assigned) for personal enjoyment or academic enrichment
10a	Hours spent per week: Preparing for class (studying, reading, writing, rehearsing, doing homework, etc.)
12d1	Frequency of use: Peer or other tutoring
12e1	Frequency of use: Skill labs (writing, math, etc.)
12h1	Frequency of use: Computer lab)

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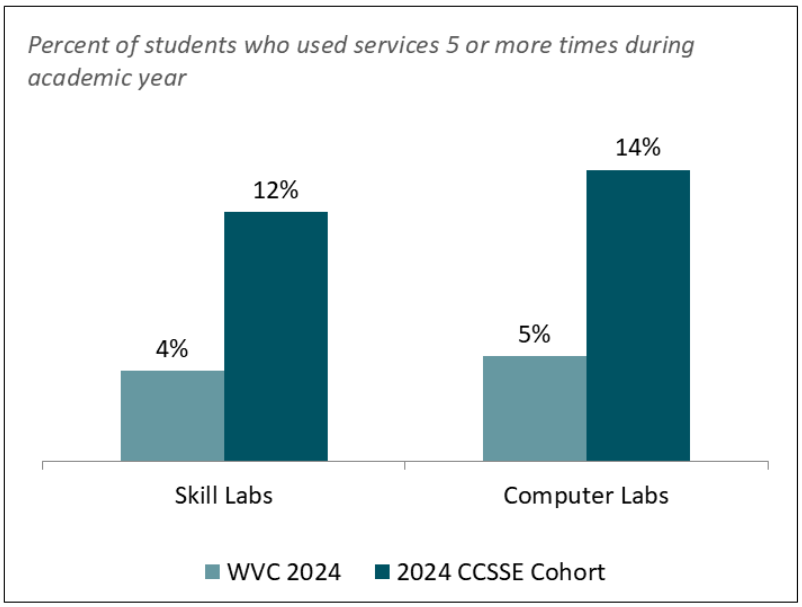
Limitations of Dimensions of Engagement

2. Student Effort



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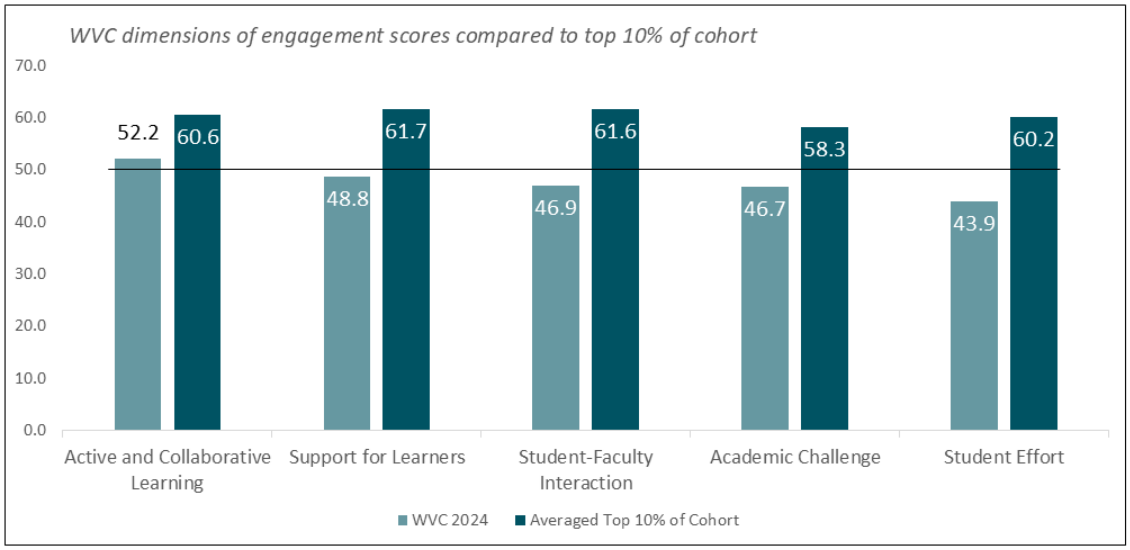
WVC has room for improvement



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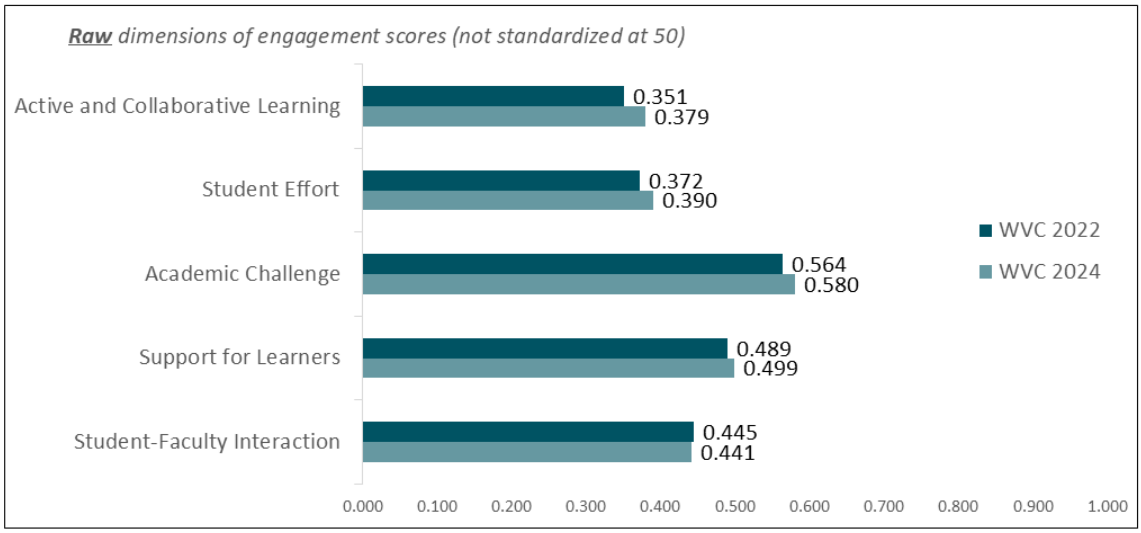
WVC made slight improvements in 4 out of 5 dimensions



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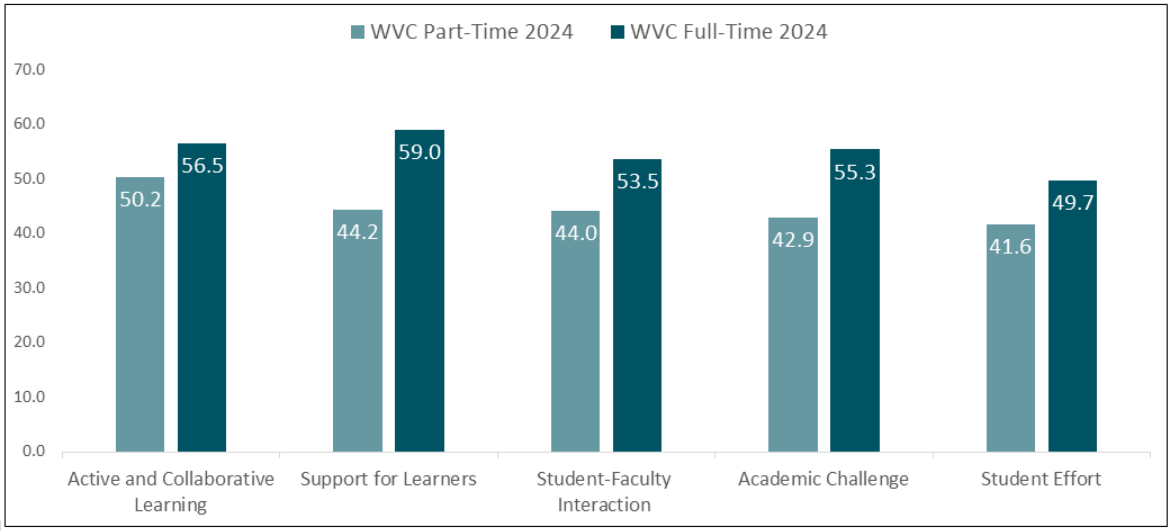
Part-time scored lower than full-time on DoE



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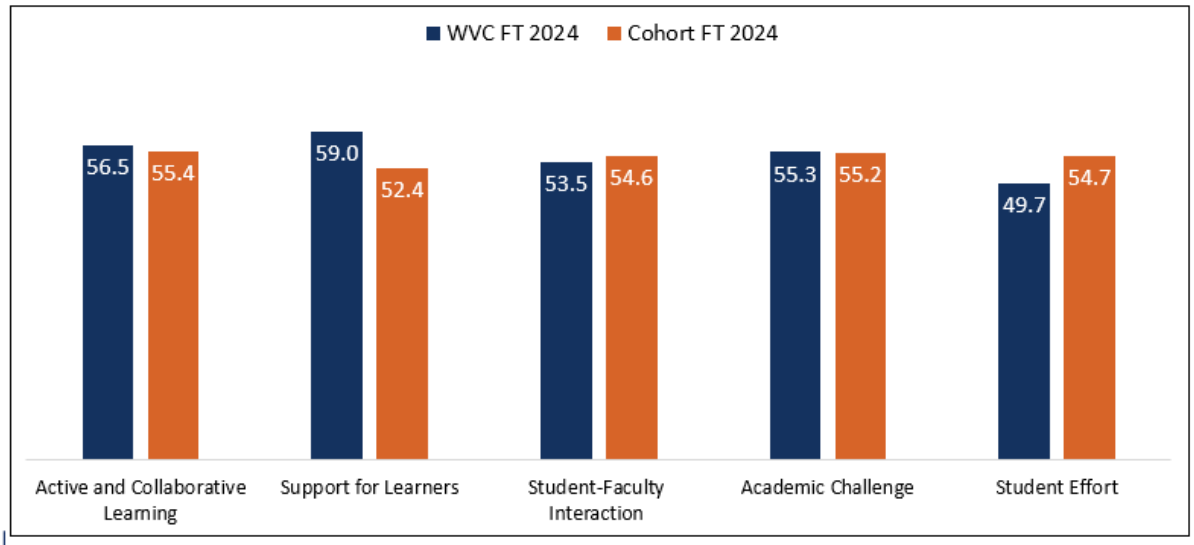
WVC full-time performed similarly to FT at medium colleges for 4 of 5



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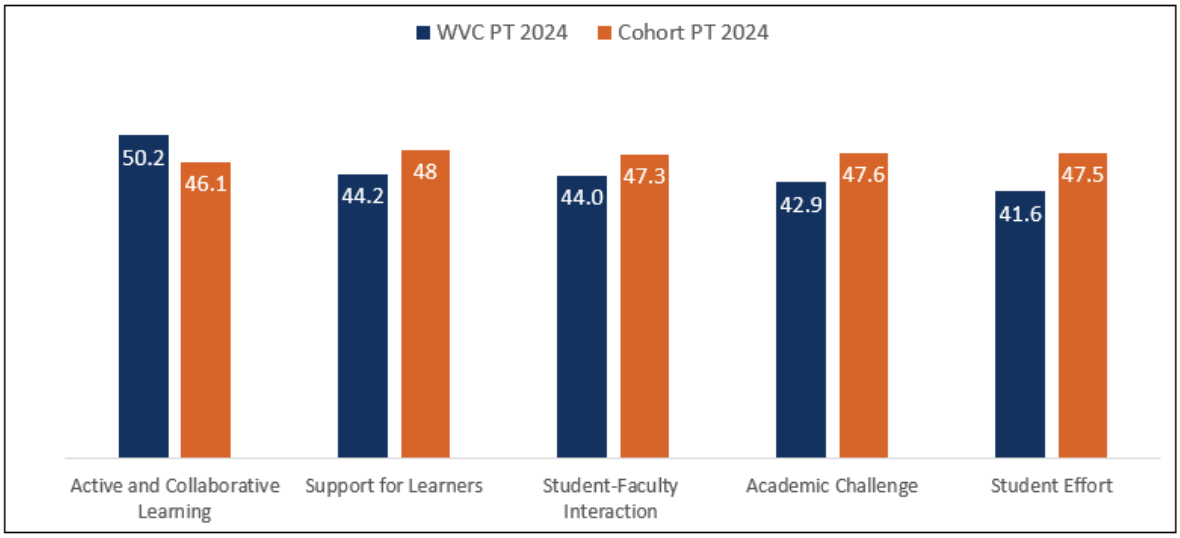
24

WVC part-time scored *lower* than PT at medium colleges for student-faculty interaction and academic challenge



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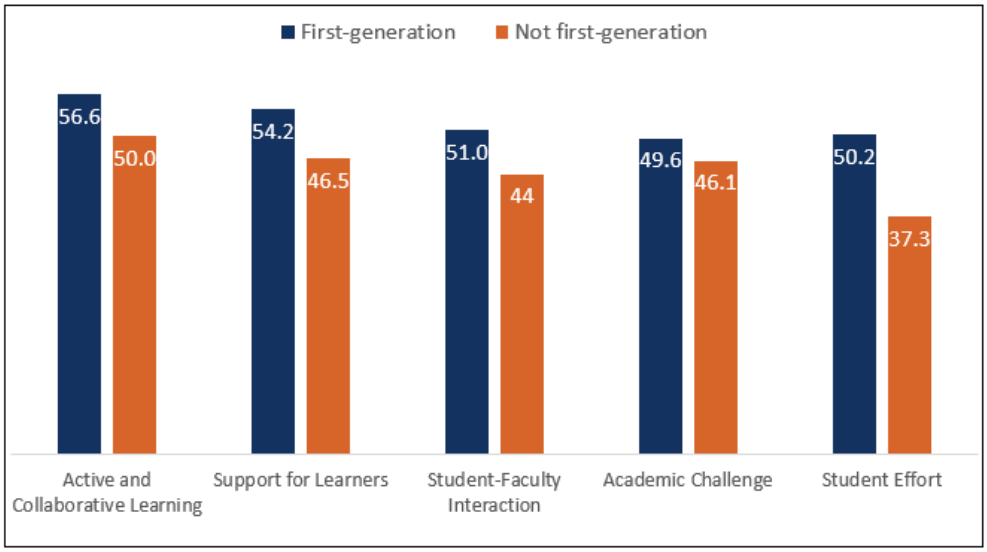
WVC first gen scored higher than non-first gen students across every dimension



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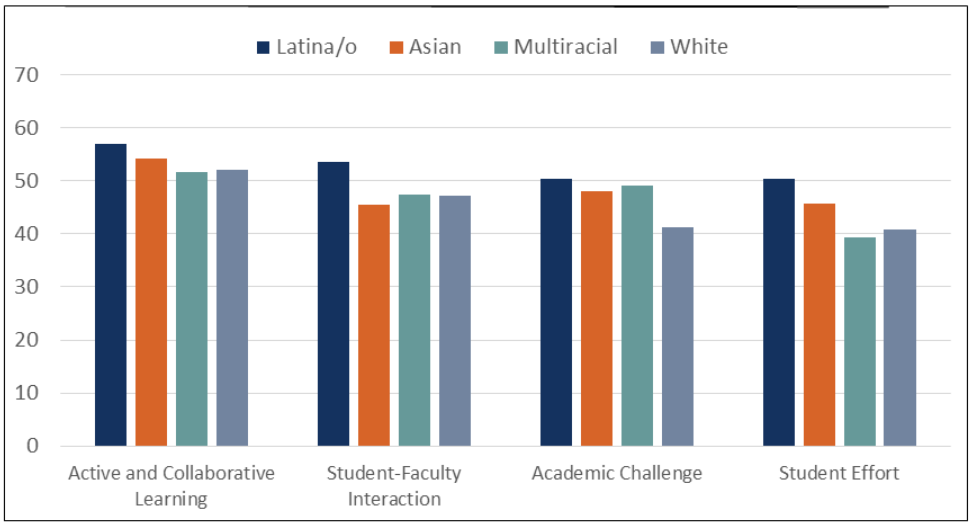
Latina/o students performed the highest across all four dimensions of engagement



Takeaways

1. **From 2022 to 2024, WVC improved across multiple measures**

2. **First gen students feel supported, performed well on DoE, and improved since 2022**

3. **WVC has room for improvement across DoE, especially for part-time students**

Appendix D. CCSSE academic slides

Overall Dimensions of Student Engagement

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Five Dimensions of Student Engagement

1. Active and Collaborative Learning
2. Student Effort
3. Academic Challenge
4. Student-Faculty Interaction
5. ~~Support for Learners~~

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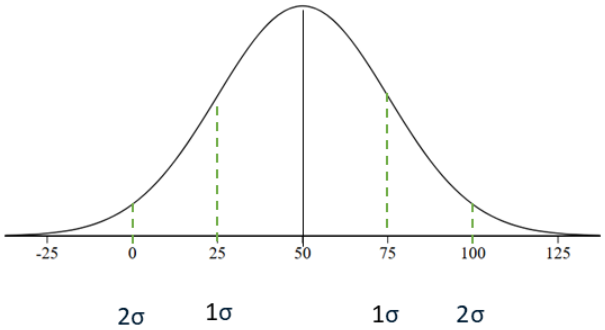
Understanding Dimensions of Engagement Score

- 25 points is one standard deviation
  - < .1 SD (~2.5 points) Very small, likely noise
  - .2 SD (~ 5 points) Small but worth noting
  - .5 SD (~12.5 points) Moderate, often meaningful
  - .8+ SD (~20+ points) Large effect, clearly significant



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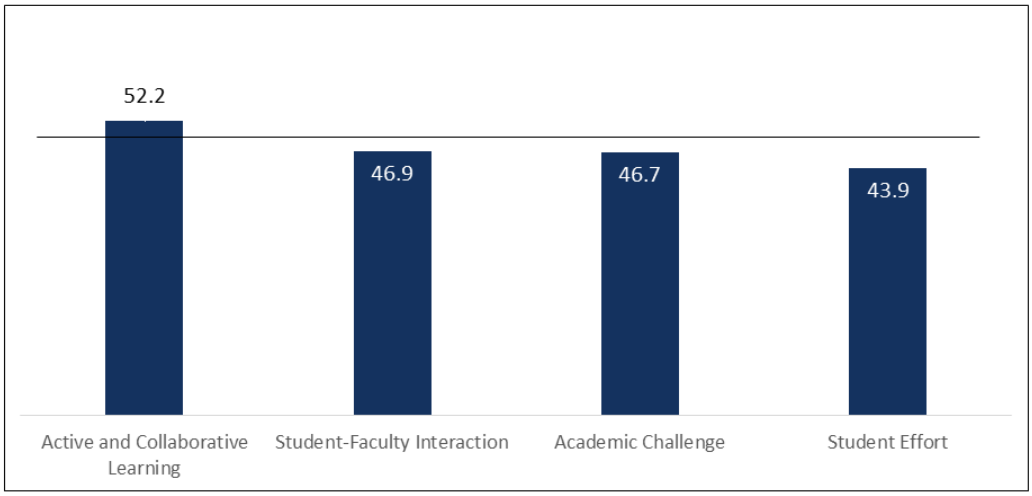
Active and Collaborative Learning was WVC's highest Dimension of Engagement



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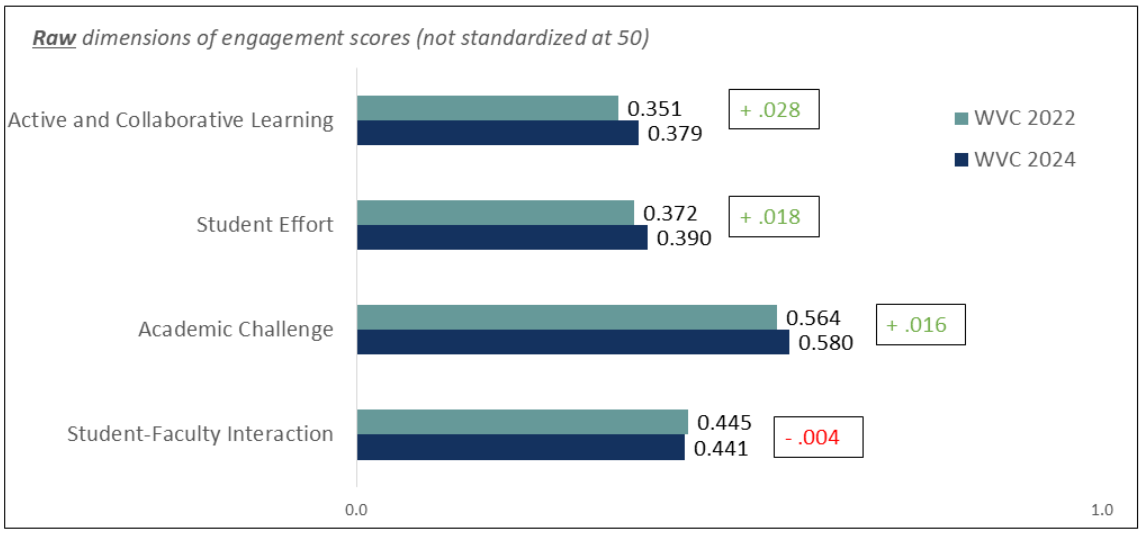
21

WVC made slight improvements in 3 out of 4 dimensions



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Detailed Dimensions of Student Engagement

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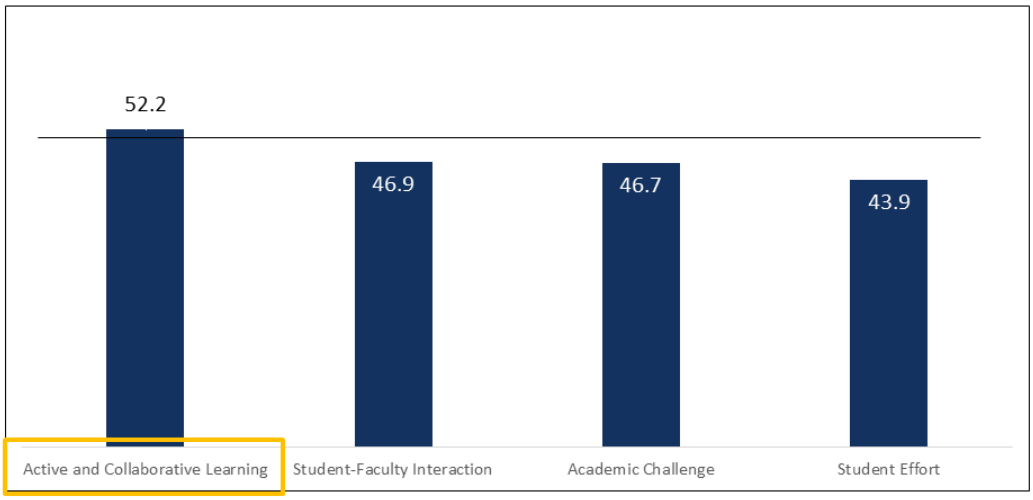
Active and Collaborative Learning: Deep Dive



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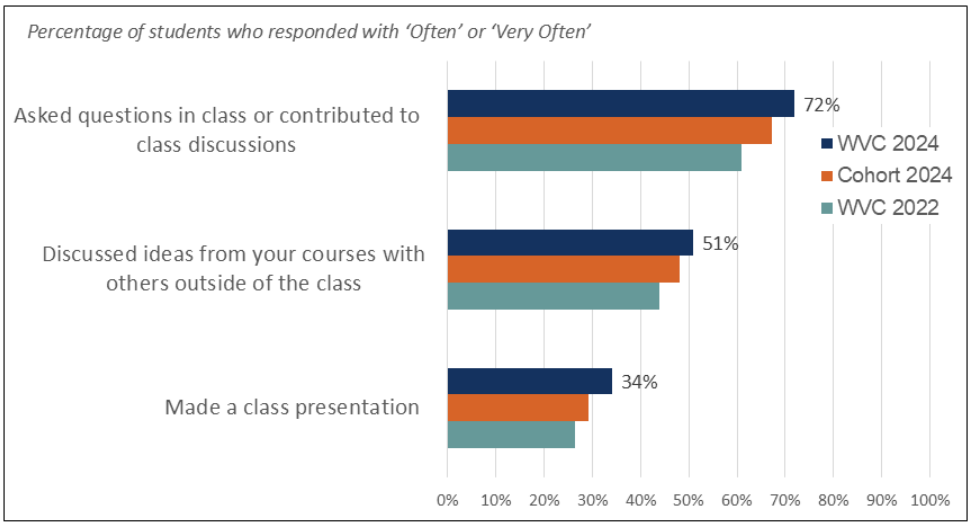
29

WVC outperformed cohort colleges and improved from '22



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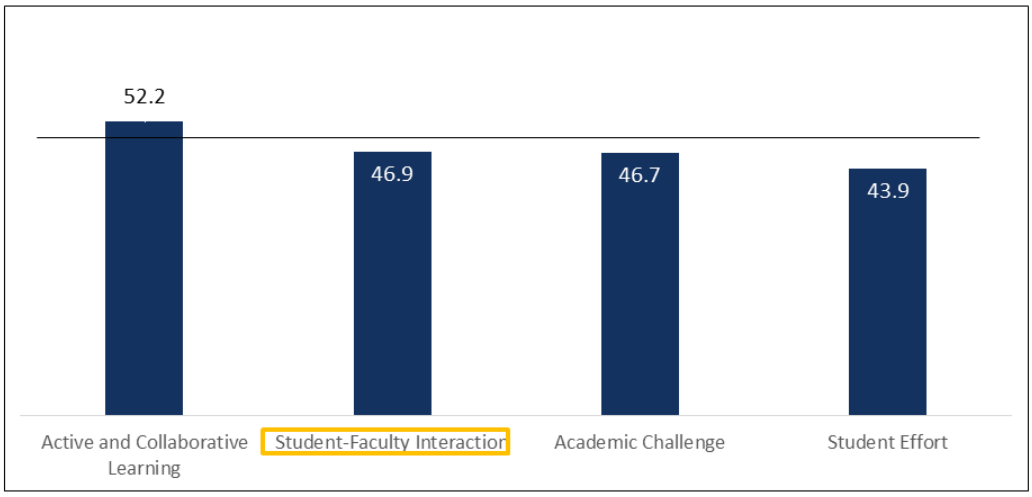
Student-Faculty Interaction: Deep Dive



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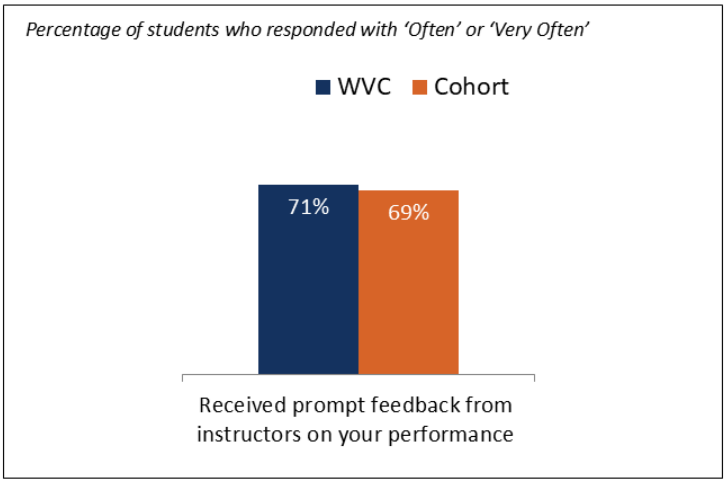
31

WVC instructors provided students feedback quickly



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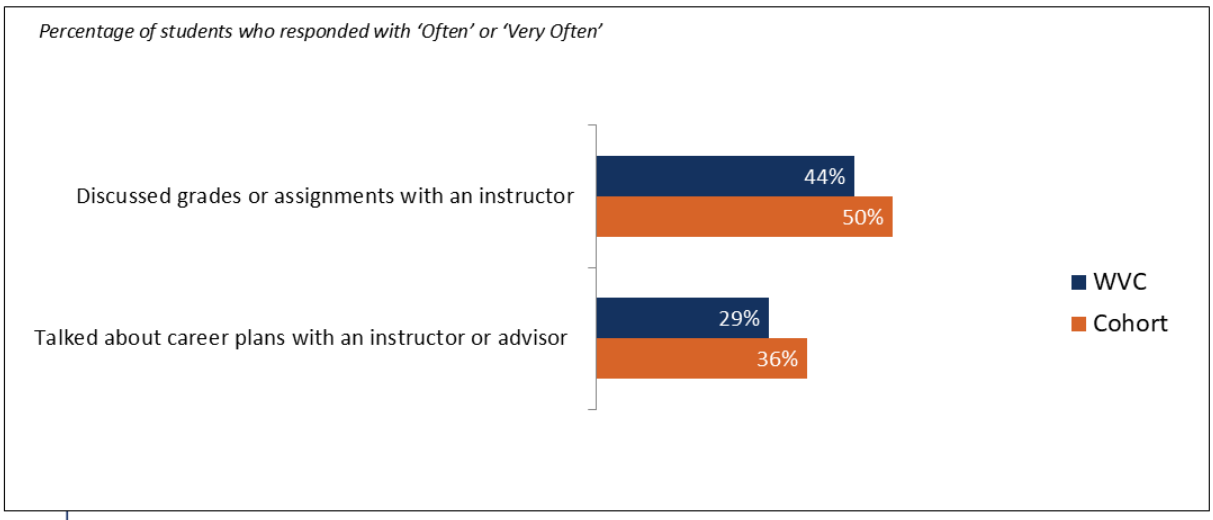
32

WVC has room to improve in how frequent instructors/advisors discuss grades, assignments and career goals with students



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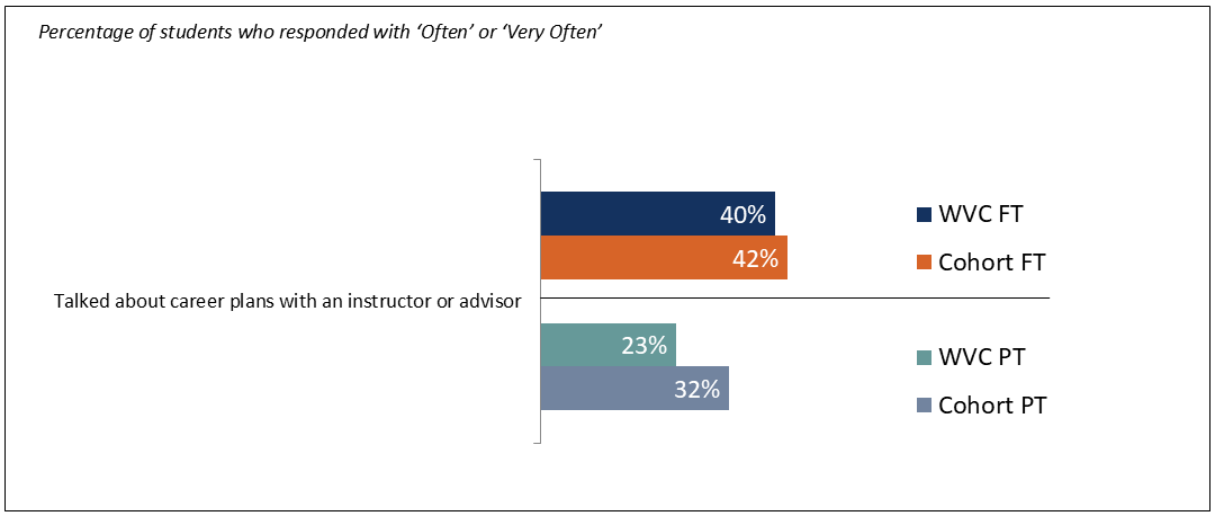
Part-time students are less likely to discuss career plans with an instructor/advisor



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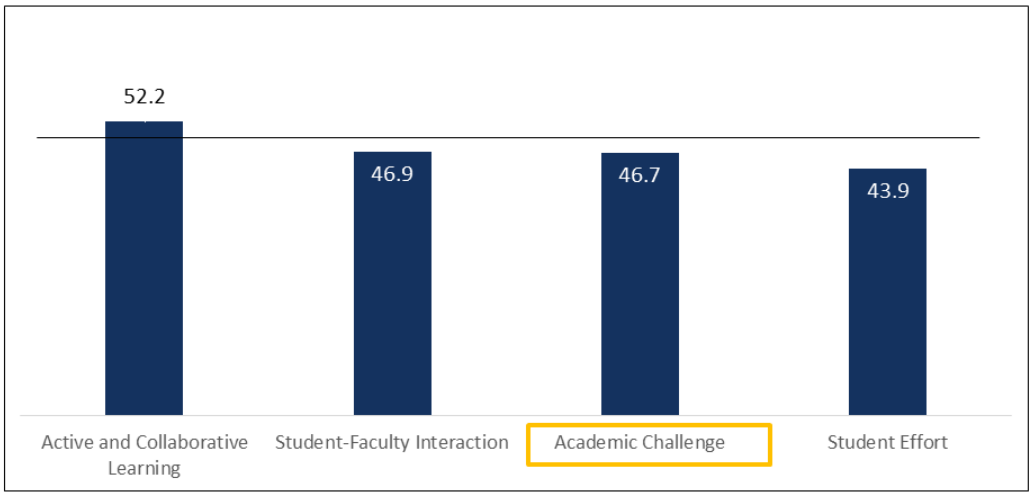
Academic Challenge: Deep Dive



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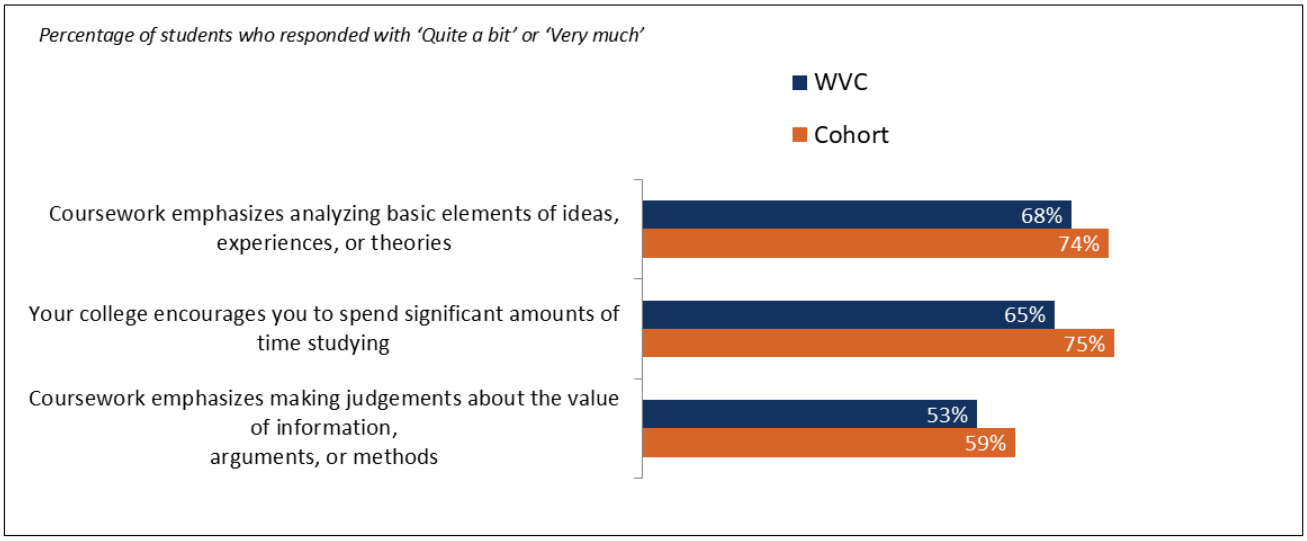
WVC has areas to improve for academic challenge



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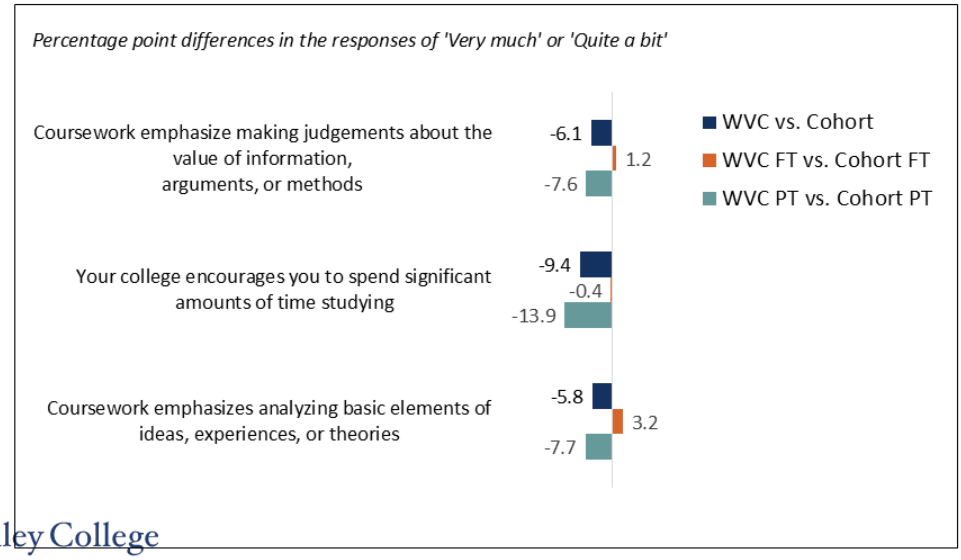
WVC part-time students scored lower than PT at cohort colleges



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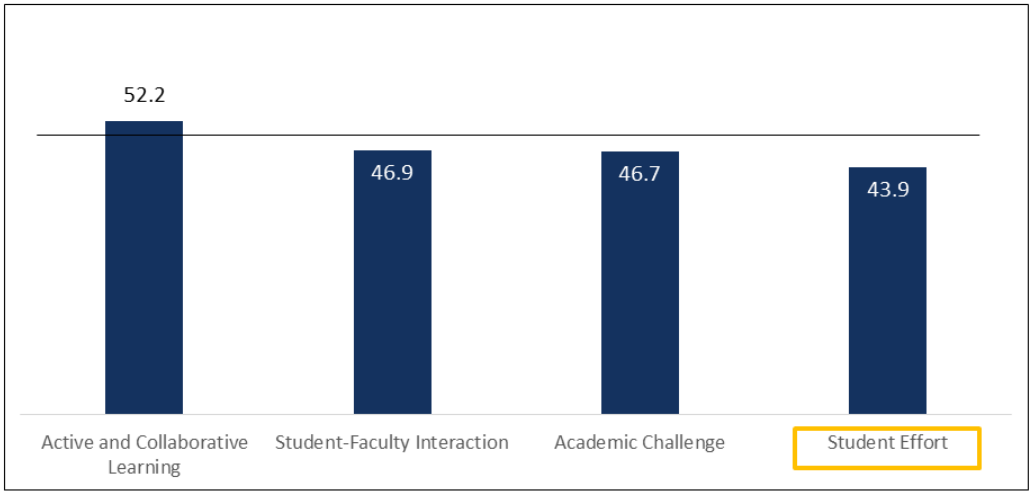
Student Effort: Deep Dive



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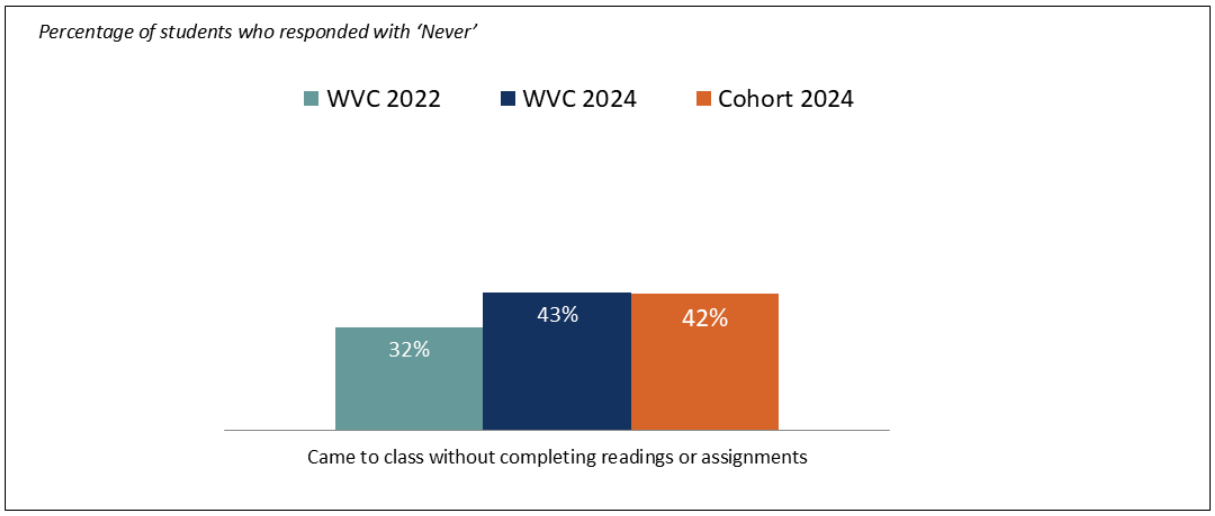
40

More WVC students came to class prepared in ’24 than in ‘22



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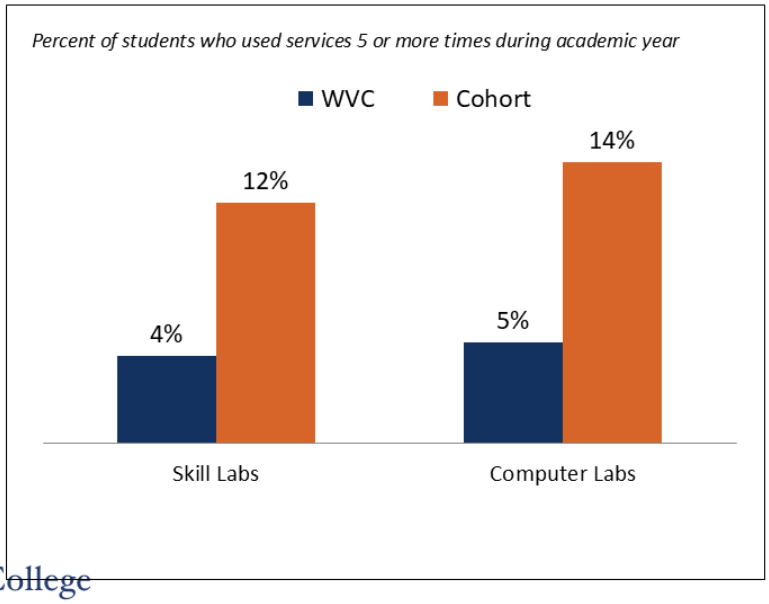
Limitations of Student Effort Score



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General Education Learning Outcomes

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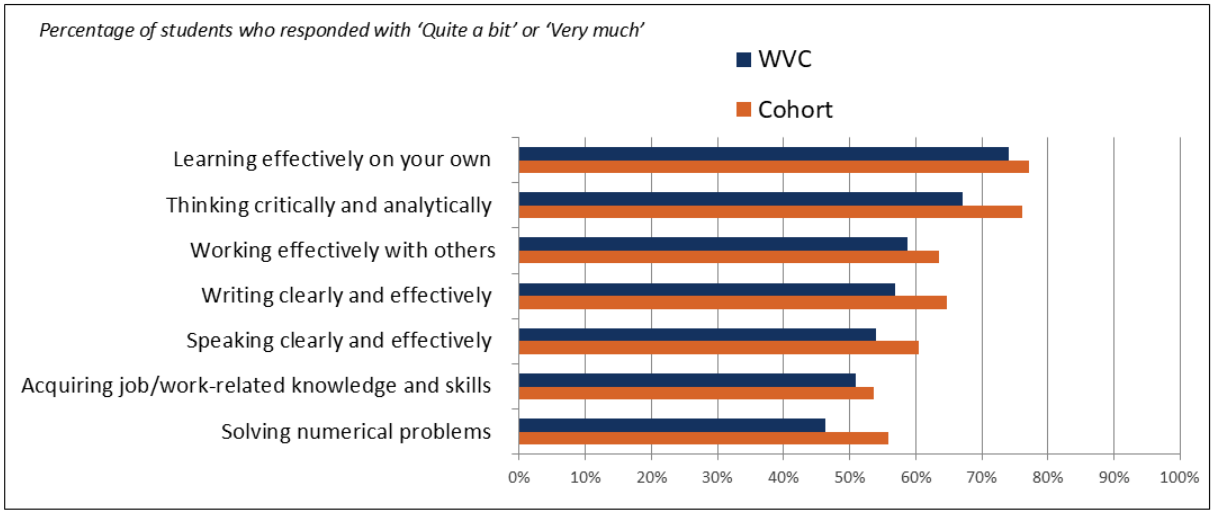
WVC scored slightly lower than students at cohort colleges across every general education learning outcomes



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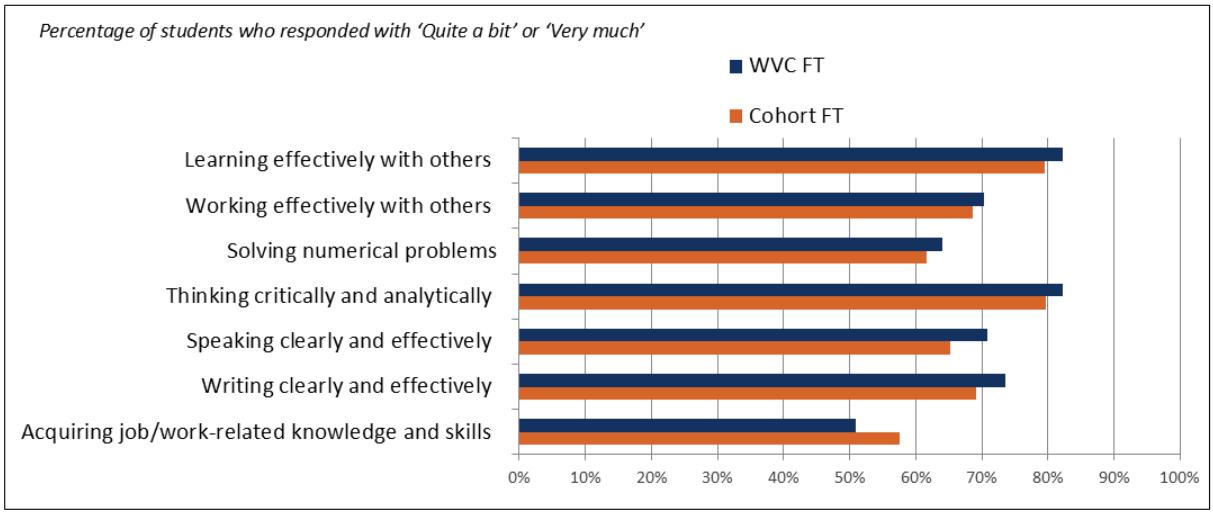
WVC FT students scored higher than cohort FT students across 6/7 questions



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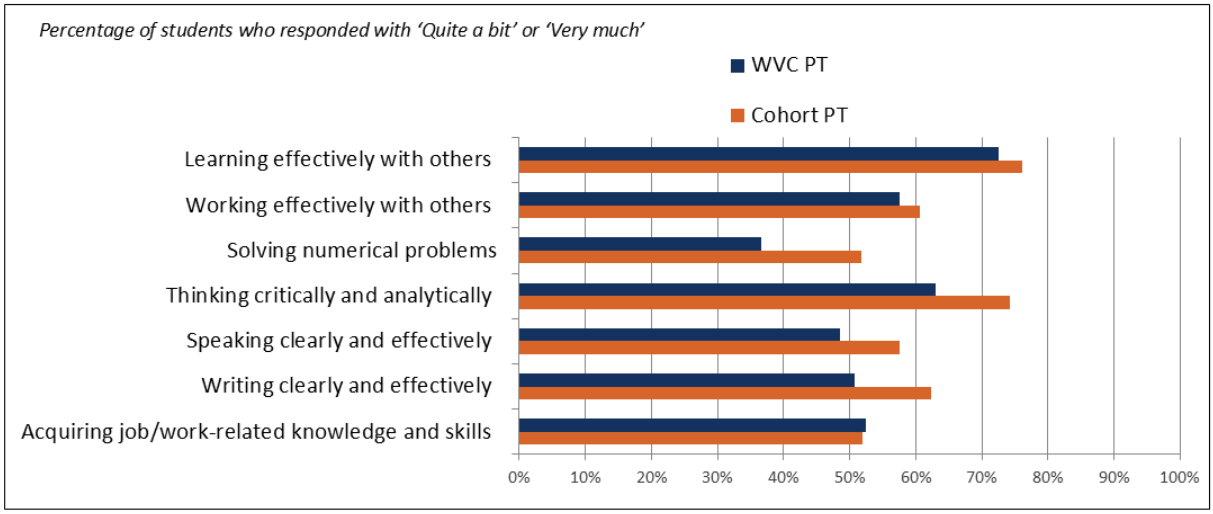
45

WVC PT students scored higher than Cohort PT students for 1/7 questions



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Takeaways

1. Students felt supported by instructors and believe they can succeed at WVC

2. Students reported high levels of collaboration and engagement within and outside the classroom

3. Part-time students seem to have lower engagement than WVC full-time students and part-time students at cohort colleges

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Appendix E. CCSSE student services slides

Overall Dimensions of Student Engagement

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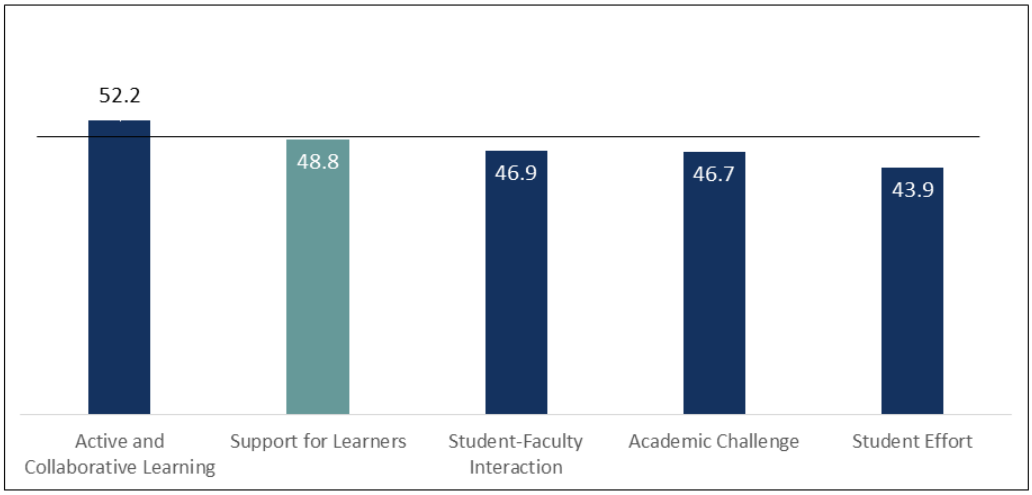
Support for Learners is one of WVC's stronger Dimensions of Engagement



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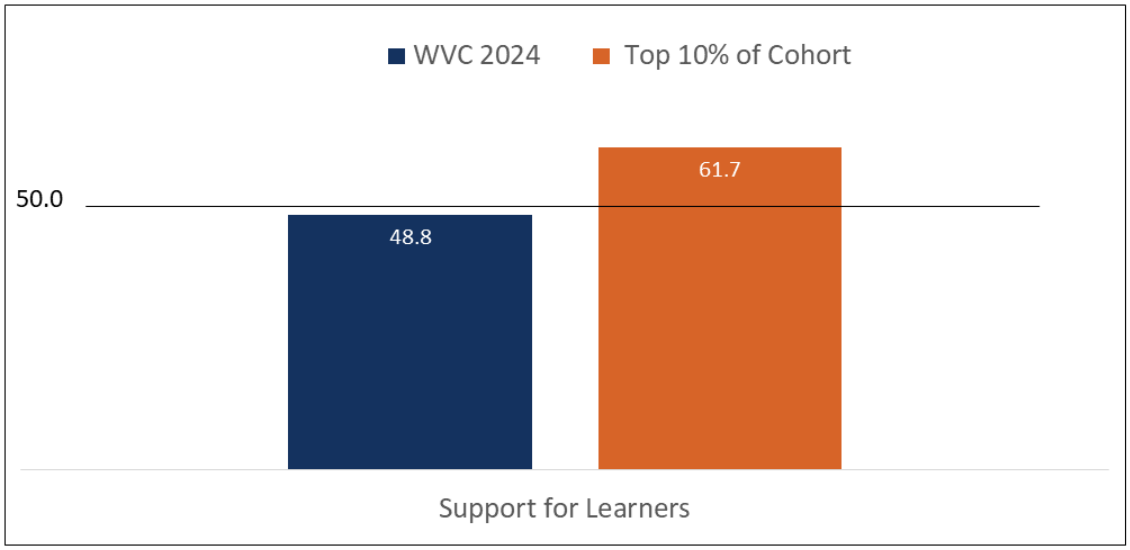
21

Support for Learners has room to improve



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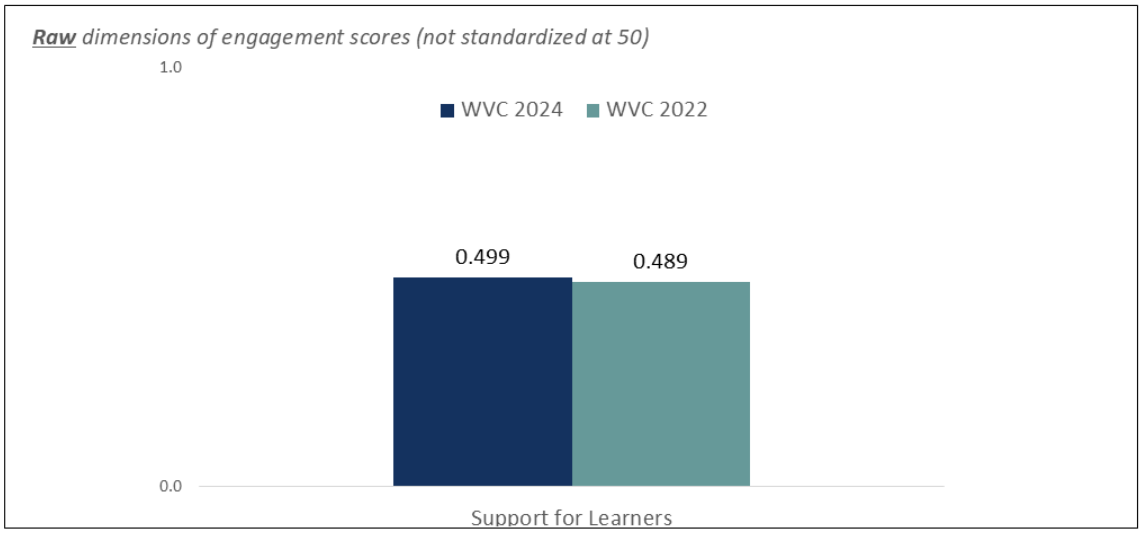
22

WVC made slight improvement in Support for Learners in '24



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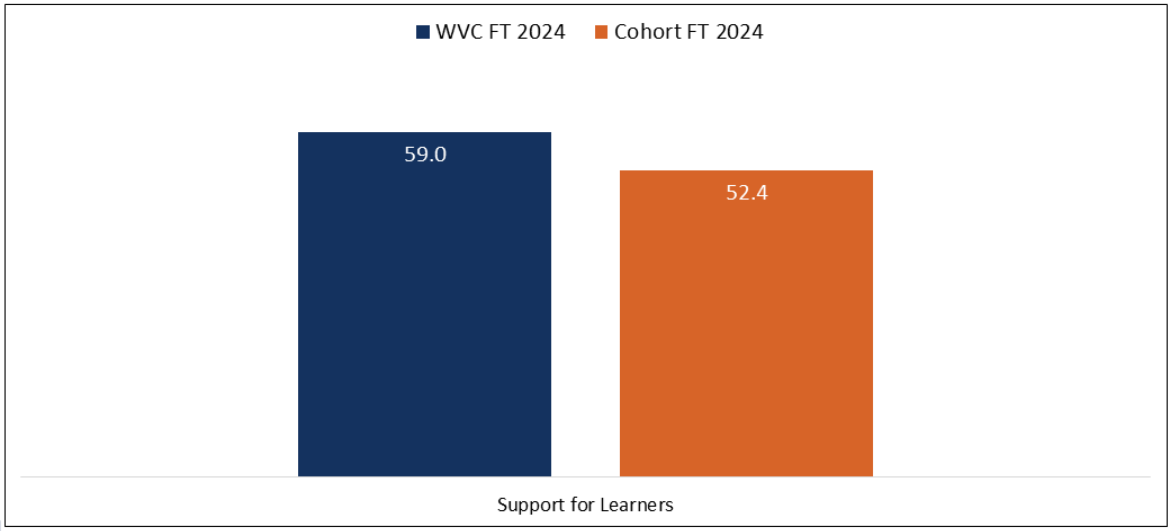
WVC full-time outperformed FT at medium colleges in Support for Learners



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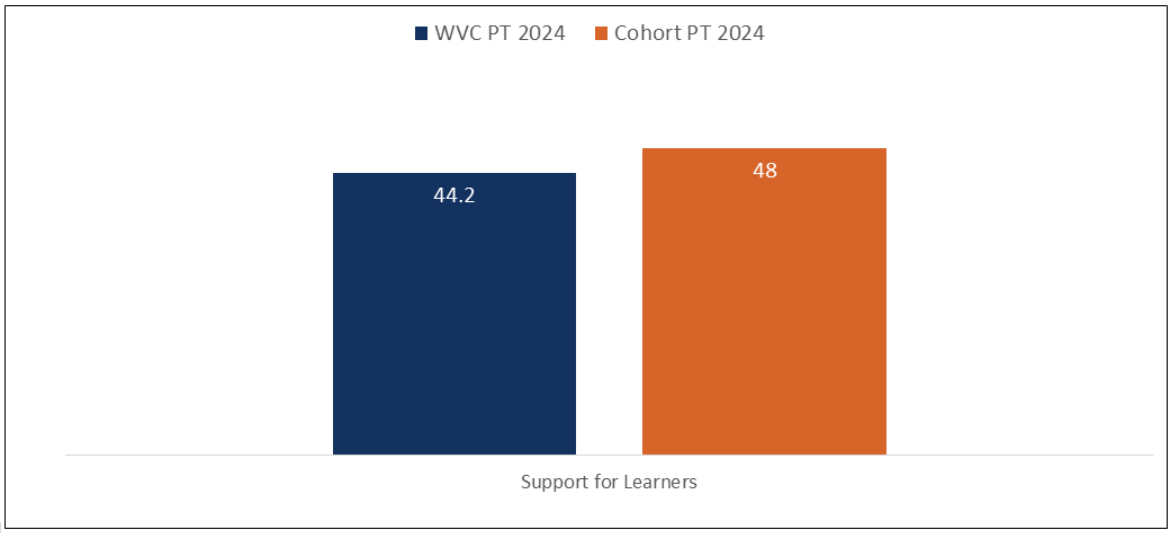
WVC part-time scored *lower* than PT at medium colleges for Support for Learners



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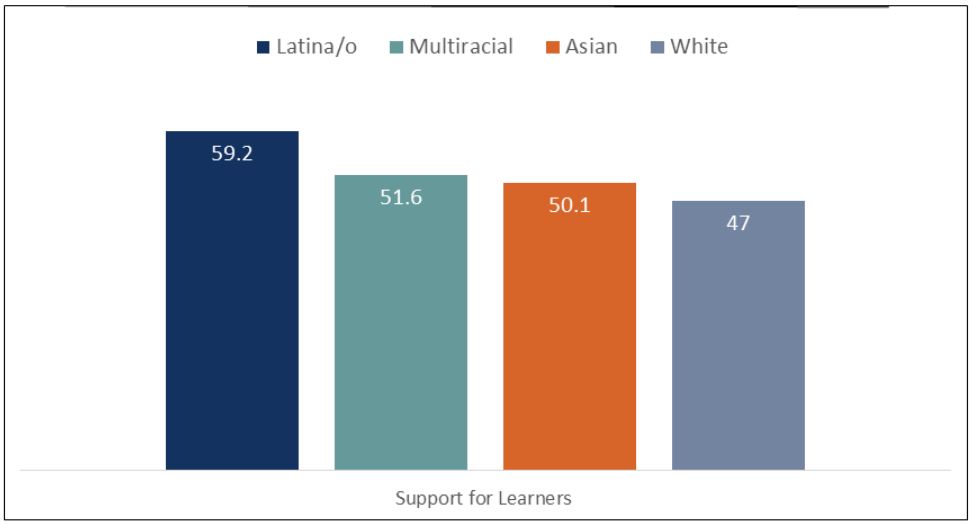
Latina/o scored very high for Support for Learners (common across dimensions of engagement)



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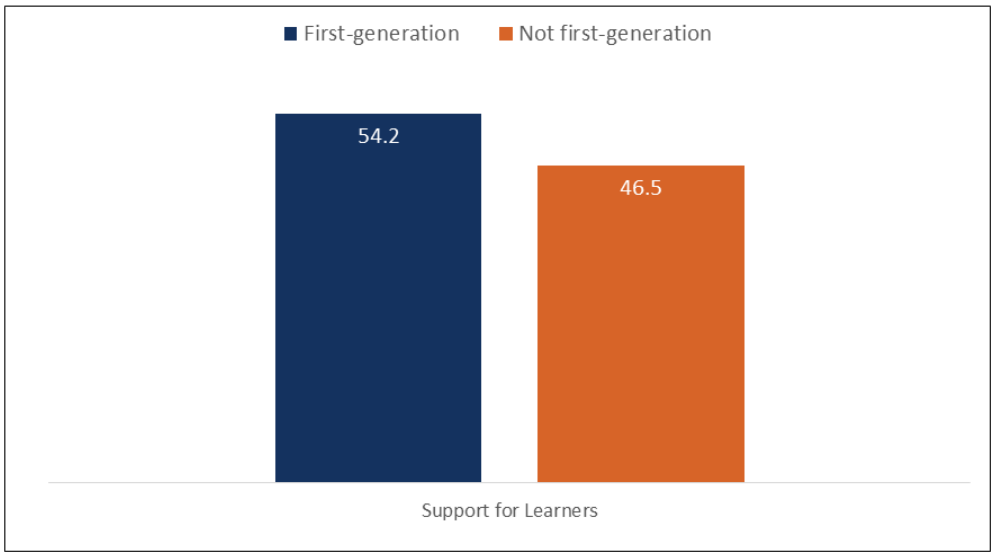
26

WVC first-gen felt supported and used services frequently



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Detailed Dimensions of Student Engagement

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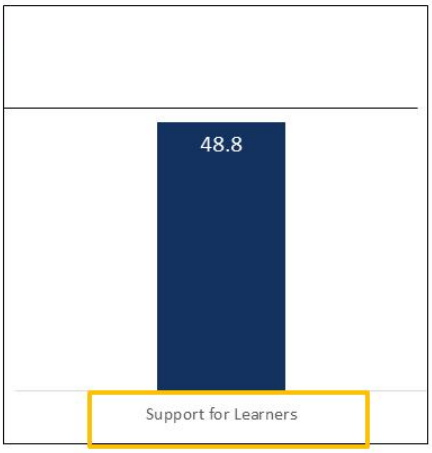
Deep Dive: Support for Learners

CCSSE Items	
9b	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the support you need to help you succeed at this college
9c	Amount of emphasis by college: Encouraging contact among students from different economic, social, and racial or ethnic backgrounds
9d	Amount of emphasis by college: Helping you cope with your non-academic responsibilities (work, family, etc.)
9e	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the support you need to thrive socially
9f	Amount of emphasis by college: Providing the financial support you need to afford your education
12a1	Frequency of use: Academic advising/planning
12b1	Frequency of use: Career counseling



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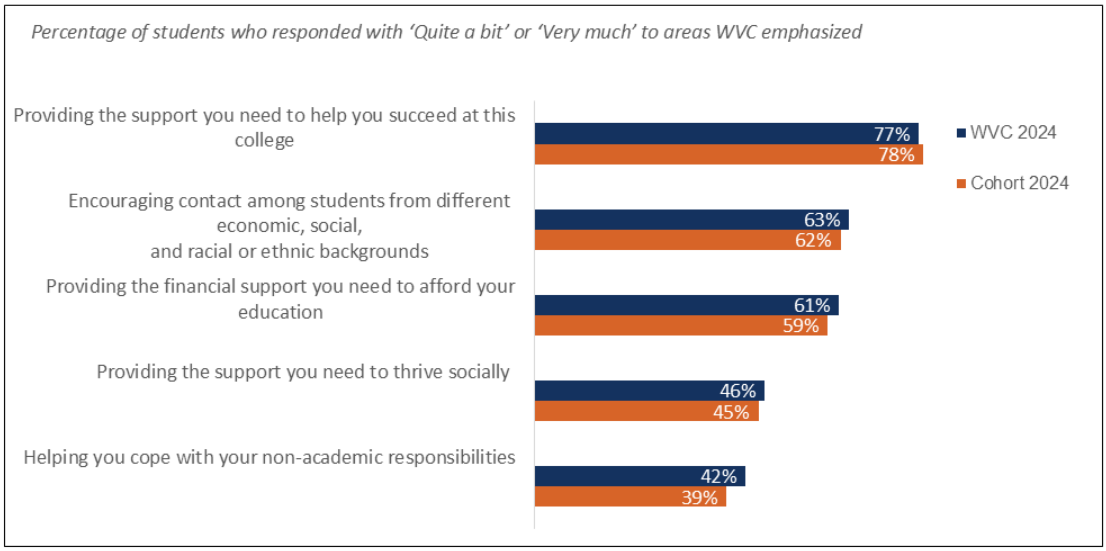
WVC students scored similarly to Cohort students across these questions



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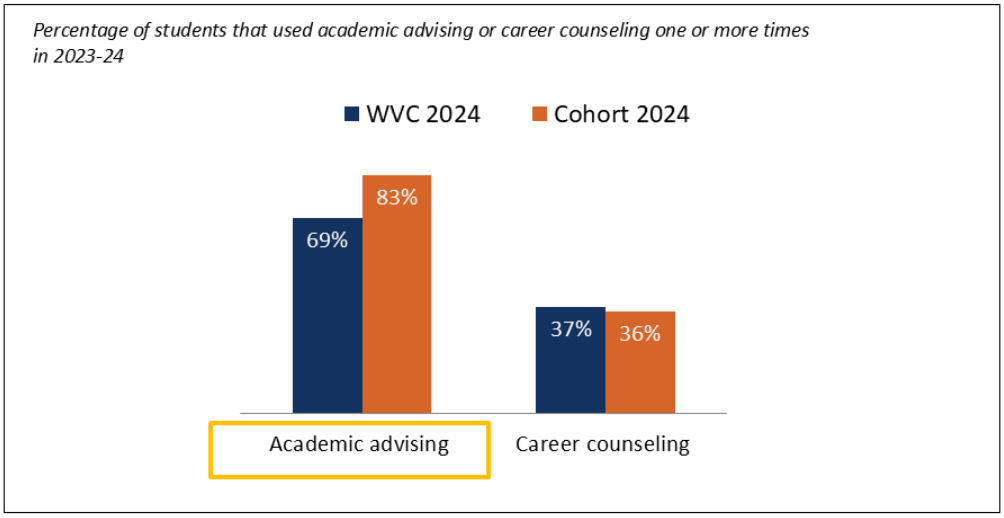
Support for Leaners was lower due to fewer students using academic advising



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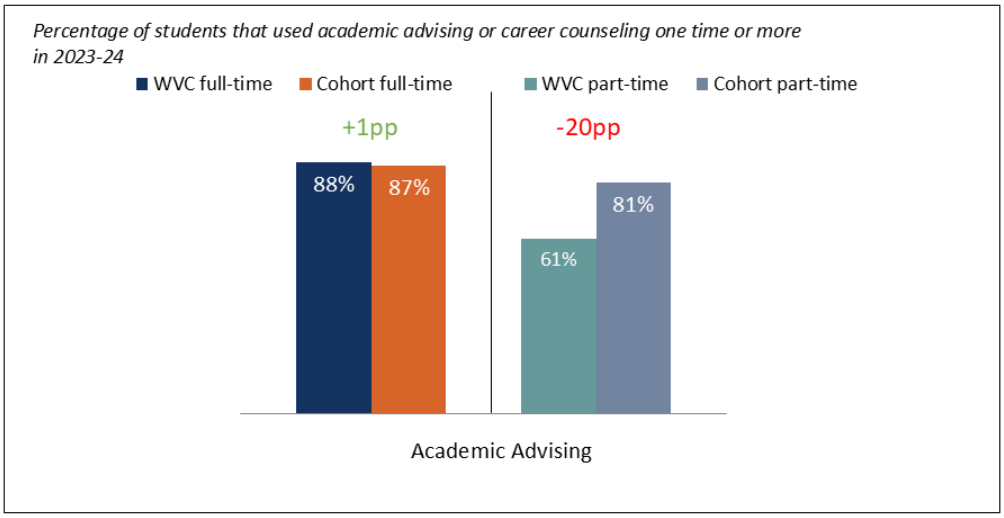
WVC part-time students reported lower usage of academic advising than WVC full-time



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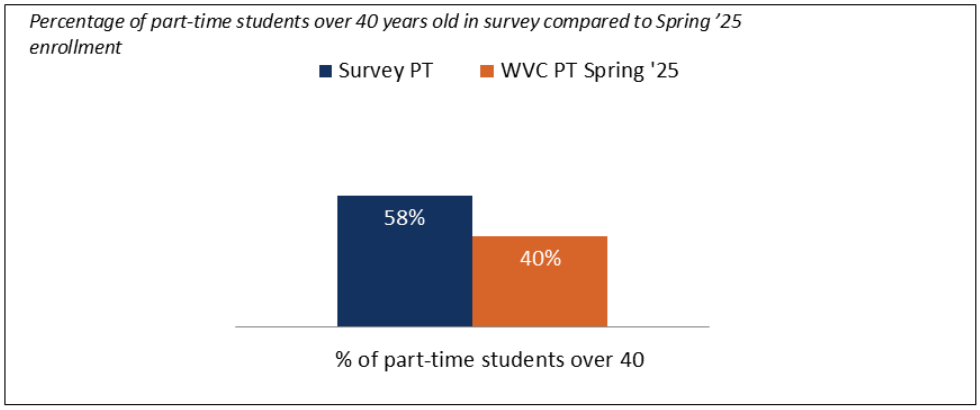
Proportion of part-time respondents over 40 years old was greater than WVC population of PT students over 40



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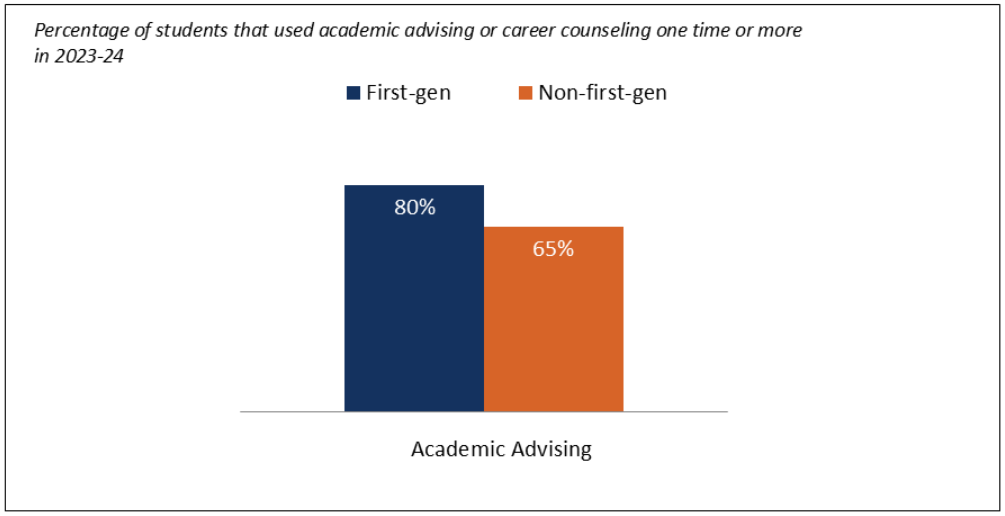
WVC first-gen students reported higher usage of academic advising than WVC non-first-gen



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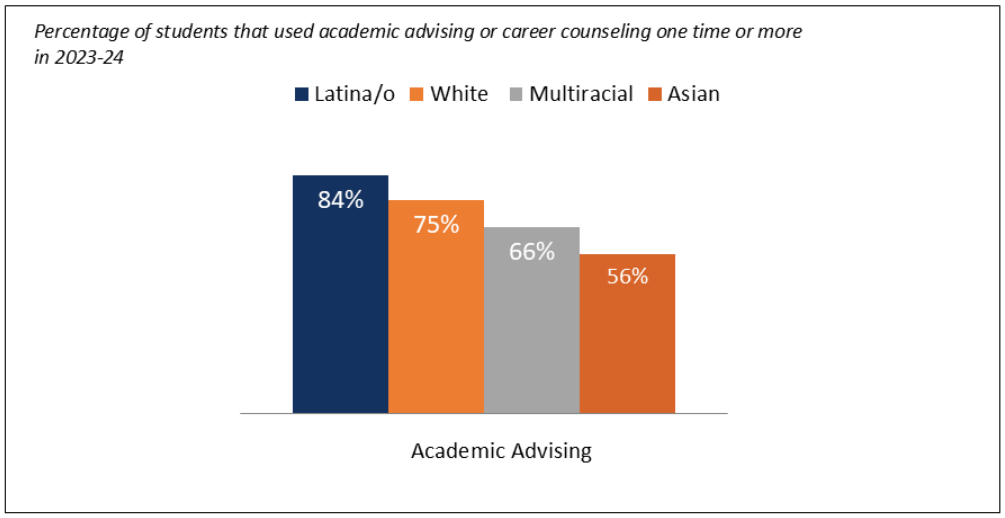
Latina/o and White students were more likely to use academic advising, while Multiracial and Aisan students were less likely.



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Satisfaction and Frequency of Services

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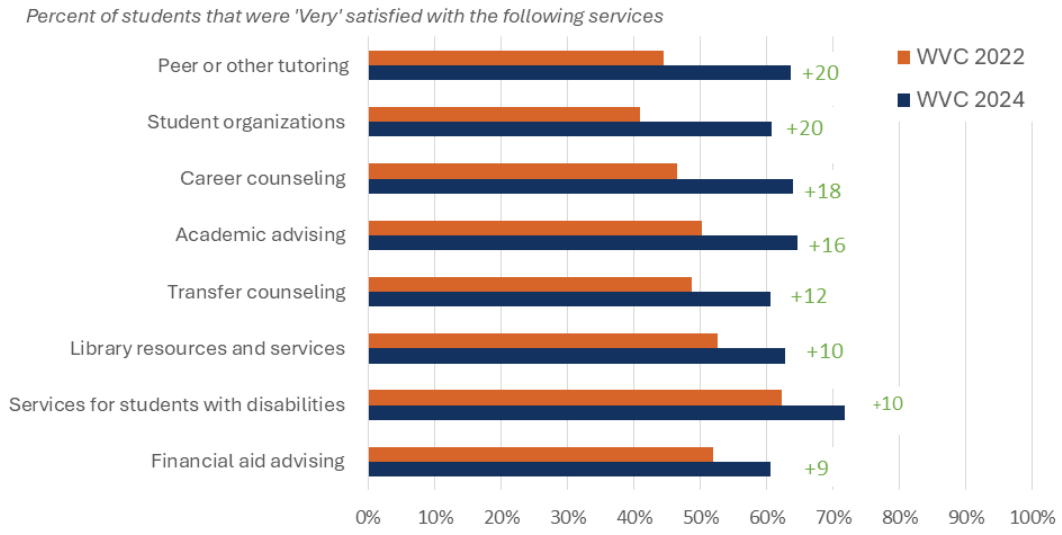
In ’24, students were more satisfied with all 8 of the services surveyed by 9 pp or more



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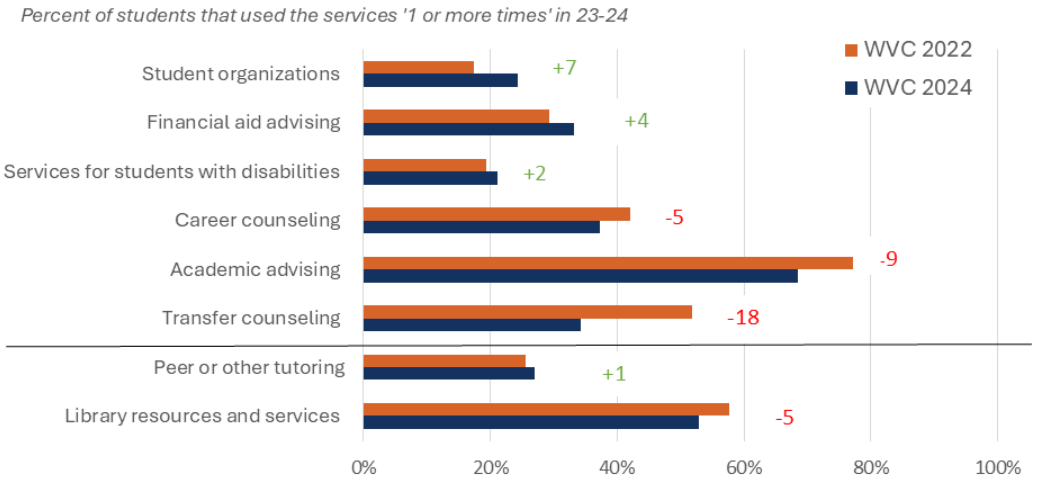
In ’24, some services received more and others received less unique student visits



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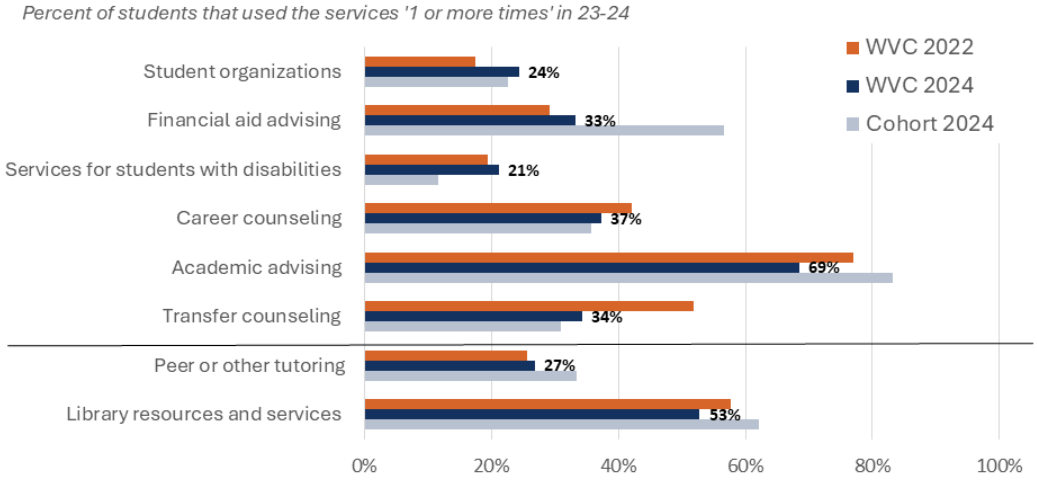
In ’24, some services received more and others received less unique student visits



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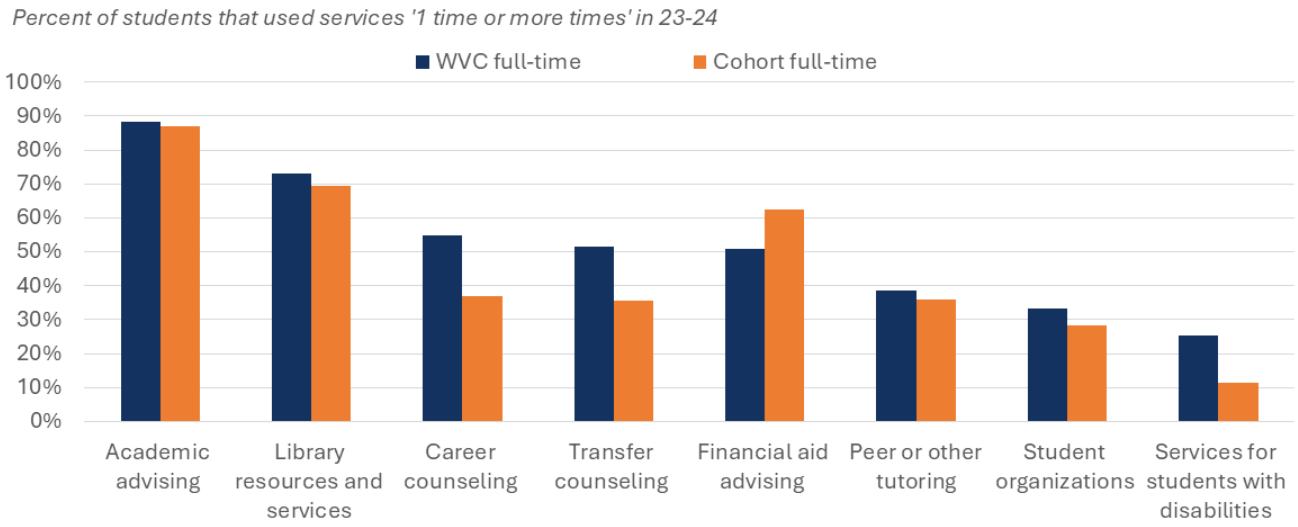
WVC full-time scored similar or better than cohort FT on most services



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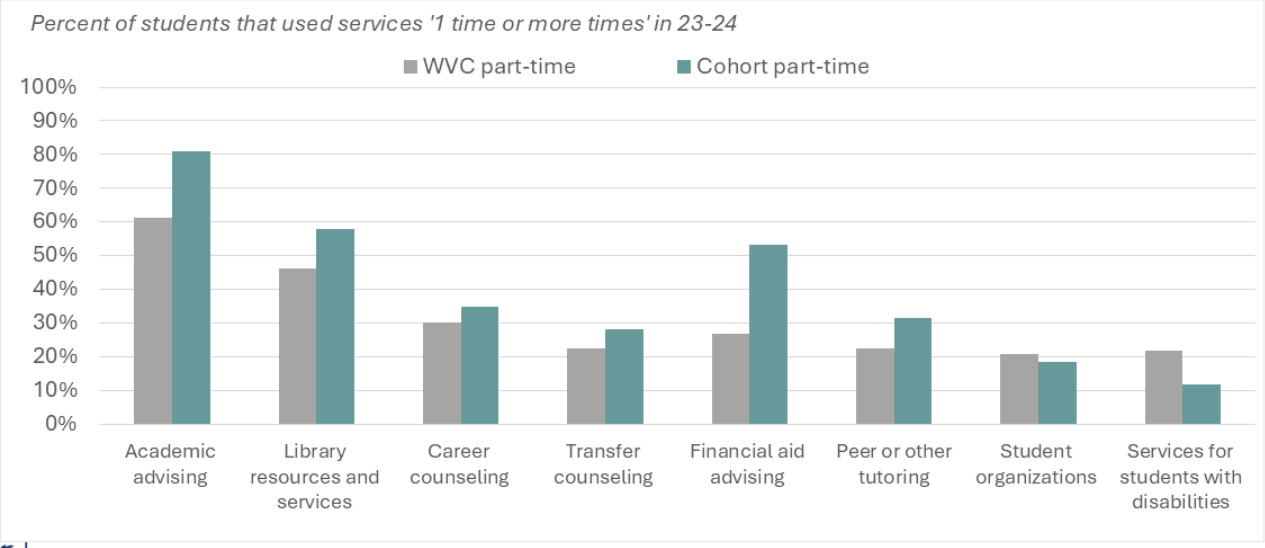
WVC part-time reported much lower scores than Cohort PT



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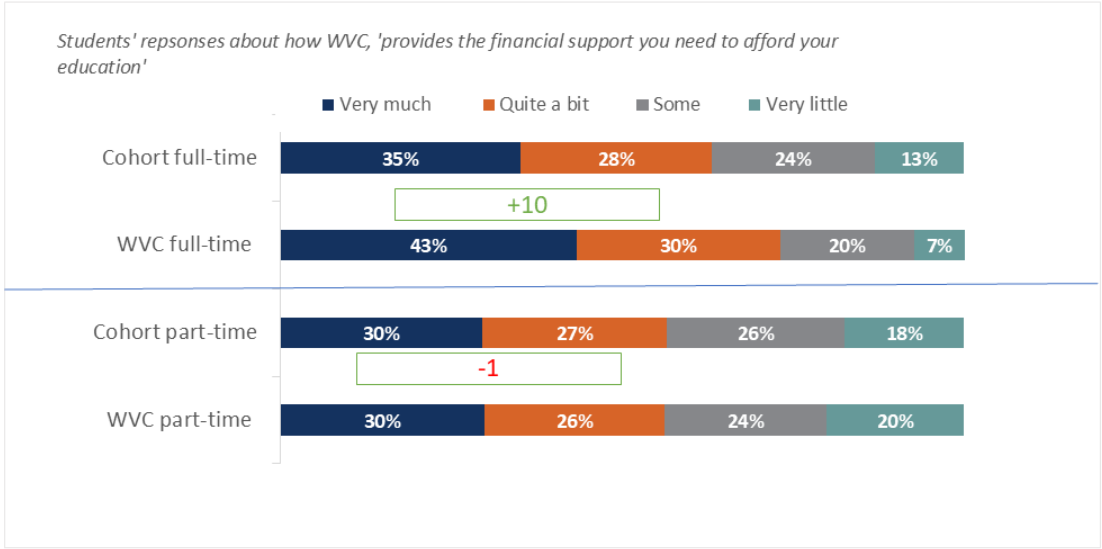
More WVC FT students felt financially supported than cohort FT, and WVC PT felt equally supported as Cohort PT



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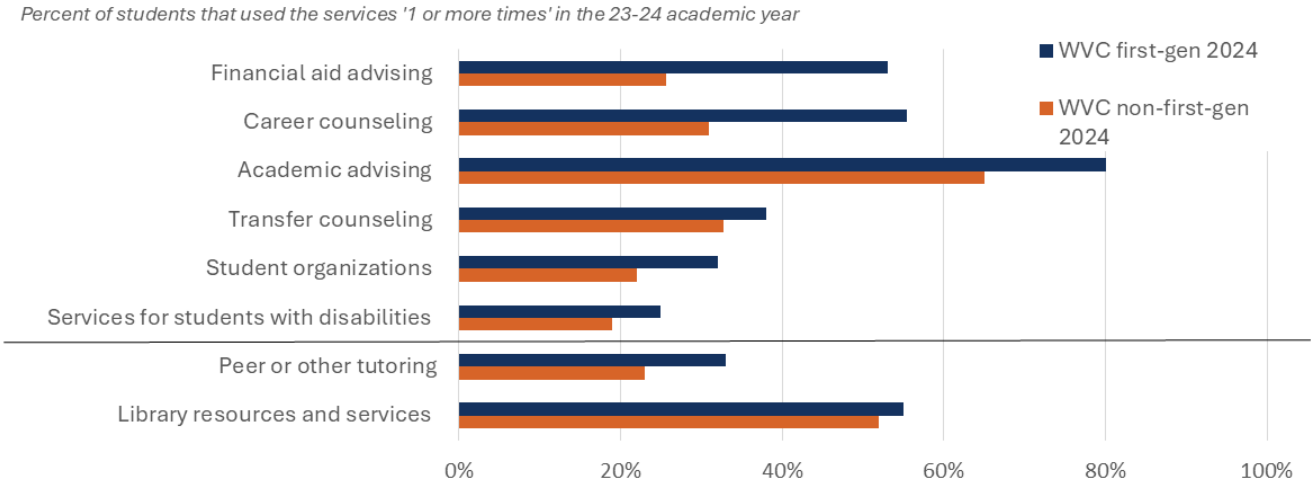
WVC first-gen used all services more frequently than non-first-gen



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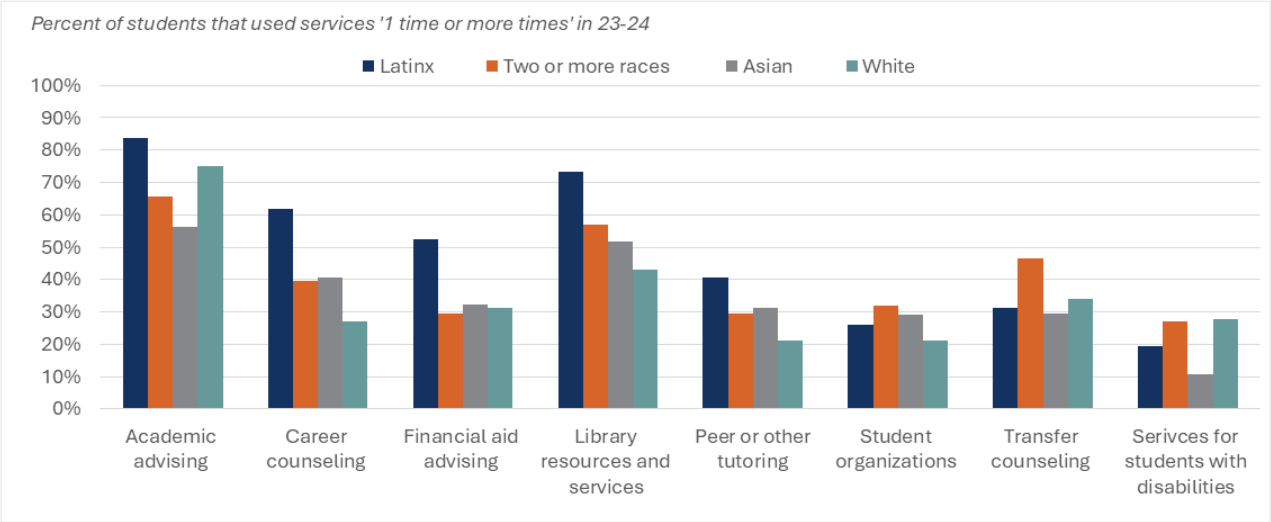
Latina/o and multi-racial students were most likely to use a service



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Takeaways

1. First-gen and students of color used services frequently, felt like they belong, and enjoyed WVC experience.

2. WVC students' satisfaction of student services dramatically increased in 2024 (9 pp or more across all services surveyed)

3. Students who are 40+ and PT aren't using services frequently. How do we want to support these students?

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